

SPICE · MEMORY · INVENTION

A world of flavor, one mixture at a time.

Measured recipes for spice jars, fresh pastes and flavor bases across the world. Explore familiar restaurant notes, surprising food transformations, and a little culinary fantasy.



AI-created editorial illustration. It is not a photograph of prepared or taste-tested recipes.

120

regional flavor entries

8 + 8

restaurant recreations + flavor
illusions

16

fantasy experiments

153

total measured entries, including
your house mix

A broad survey of named traditions and home interpretations across all inhabited continents; not an exhaustive record of every culture or household. Regional and Indigenous traditions extend far beyond these examples. Recipes have not been kitchen-tested or clinically reviewed.

Build the flavor, then choose the form.

Dry jars

Use level measuring spoons. Here, 1 tbsp = 3 tsp and 1 cup = 16 tbsp; a teaspoon is about 5 mL. Powder density varies, so grams are not guessed from spoons. Whole seeds and ground powders are named separately.

The colored ribbon compares ingredient volumes only when every measure is compatible. It shows the measured proportions before mixing, not final yield or nutrition.

Fresh foundations

A dry jar cannot stand in for every tradition. Sofrito, mojo, kroeung, adobo and herb sauces also need fresh aromatics, liquids and cooking technique. Storage and starting doses appear with each entry.

Refrigerate fresh mixtures promptly at 4°C / 40°F or colder. Garlic and herbs in oil must be used within 4 days or frozen. A splash of acid does not certify shelf stability.

Taste with context

Start with a small amount in cooked food, then change one ingredient at a time. Cultural recipes vary by region, family and purpose; a pantry substitute is labeled as an adaptation.

Check allergens and ingredient labels, including sauces, sesame, mustard, nuts, soy and dairy. No recipe here is automatically kidney-safe, sodium-free, or a substitute for individualized dietary guidance.

Storage reference: [Oregon State University Extension — herbs and vegetables in oil.](#)

Does that exact twelve-spice mixture have a name?

I have not verified an established name for that exact list. Onion, garlic, chili powder, cayenne, coriander, cumin, black pepper, turmeric, clove, paprika, ground mustard and ginger place it closest to a *curry-style all-purpose house seasoning*. That is a descriptive classification, not a confirmed traditional identity.

Your proportions were not supplied. “Andre’s Twelve” is a suggested starting recipe in this atlas, not a reconstruction of your actual mixture. In American shops, chili powder can already be a blend; a pure ground chile keeps the ingredient list at exactly twelve. Garam masala and za’atar are different flavor families.

The recipe below uses only your named twelve ingredients and clearly records the proposed amounts. Keep clove restrained and tune the heat after tasting cooked food.

[Jump to the proposed house batch →](#)

Find your next flavor.

Regional entries name the tradition they draw from. Restaurant entries are home approximations; fantasy entries are original inventions with ordinary culinary ingredients.

Golden curry powder	Herby za'atar	Baharat, warm paprika version
Ras el hanout, pantry edition	Berberie-inspired chili blend	Crunchy dukkah
Harissa-style red chili paste	Green chermoula	Tabil-style coriander mix
Hawaij for soup	Advieh berenj-style rice spice	Kabsa-style warm spice mix
Toum-style garlic emulsion	Green zhug / schug	Suya-style peanut seasoning
Kelewele-style ginger coat	Nokoss-style aromatic base	Cameroonian green spices
Maafe-inspired peanut-tomato base	Braai-style coriander rub	East African pilau-style masala
Nyama choma-style lemon garlic marinade	Xawaash, ground pantry version	Sakay-style chili ginger condiment
Cajun paprika & pepper rub	Creole garden-herb seasoning	Memphis-style sweet paprika BBQ dust
Chesapeake celery-spice dust · Old Bay-inspired	American sage & thyme roast seasoning	Montréal-style cracked pepper & coriander
Mexican-American chile & oregano taco blend	Mexican ancho-guajillo adobo base	Yucatán-style achiote recado rojo
Puerto Rican-style annatto sazón	Puerto Rican-style adobo seco	Puerto Rican green sofrito / recaíto
Cuban-style garlic-citrus mojo	Dominican-style fresh sazón	Jamaican-inspired jerk paste
Trinidad-style green seasoning	Haitian-inspired epis	Bahia-inspired tempero baiano
Argentine-style parsley chimichurri	Peruvian-inspired ají amarillo aderezo	Merkén-inspired smoky chile & coriander
Colombian-style tomato-scallion hogao	Bolivian-style locoto llajua	Ecuadorian-style ají criollo
Italian-American pantry herb blend	Ligurian-style basil pesto	Sicilian-style salmoriglio
Herbes de Provence	Fresh fines herbes	Quatre épices
Spanish-inspired paprika and garlic blend	Catalan-style almond picada	Portuguese-style piri-iri sauce
Greek-style oregano and lemon dressing	Turkish-inspired pul biber and sumac sprinkle	Khmeli suneli-inspired herb blend
Georgian-style fresh adjika	Bulgarian-style sharena sol	Balkan čevapi-inspired savory seasoning
Hungarian-inspired paprika and caraway	Polish-inspired marjoram and garlic	German-inspired mustard and caraway
British-inspired sage and onion seasoning	Irish-inspired parsley and chive butter	Swedish-style mustard and dill sauce
Finnish-inspired dill and forest spice	Ukrainian-style fresh dill and garlic base	Romanian-style mujdei
Garam masala • warming finish	Chaat masala • tart finishing dust	Tandoori-style red spice base
Panch phoron • whole five-seed tempering	Sambar-style roasted spice powder	Sri Lankan-style roasted curry powder
Momo-style filling masala	Karahi-style coriander-pepper mix	Char masala • Afghan-style rice warmth
Chinese five-spice • anise-led	Sichuan mala finishing dust	Cantonese-style ginger-scallion sauce
Shichimi-style seven-spice	Nori-sesame furikake-style sprinkle	Gochujang bowl sauce
Gochugaru-sesame finishing blend	Thai-style red curry paste	Toasted-rice larb accent
Vietnamese-style lemongrass marinade	Khmer-style yellow kroeing	Lao jeow-style roasted chili relish
Filipino adobo • liquid braising base	Inasal-style citrus-lemongrass marinade	Balado-style red chili bumbu
Malay-style rempah aromatic base	Singapore-style laksa aromatic paste	Myanmar-style onion curry base
Taiwanese-style salt-pepper dust	Hawai'i shoyu poke-style dressing	Lemon-myrtle herb blend

Pacific-inspired coconut-lime marinade	Bhutan-inspired tomato-chili ezay	Yoruba-style efo riro pepper-and-green foundation
Nigerian ogbono-style seed foundation	Mozambique-inspired lemon piri-piri base	Congolese-inspired spinach and peanut foundation
Maple-juniper-sumac vegetable dust	Guatemalan-inspired toasted-seed pepián recado	Venezuelan-style avocado guasacaca
Barbados-inspired marjoram green seasoning	Uzbek zirvak-inspired carrot-cumin base	Tajik qurutob-inspired yogurt-onion sauce
Kazakh tuzdyk-style onion broth	Mongolian buuz-inspired onion-garlic foundation	Tibetan momo-inspired ginger-scallion base
Samoan palusami-inspired coconut-onion sauce	Tongan lū-inspired coconut-tomato foundation	Hawaiian 'inamona-inspired macadamia sprinkle
Andre's Twelve — suggested starting batch	Big Mac-style pickle-mustard burger sauce	Chick-fil-A-style smoky mustard dip
Cane's-inspired peppery tomato dip	KFC-inspired pepper & herb seasoning	Chipotle-style smoky adobo marinade
Panda-style orange glaze	Wingstop-style lemon-pepper butter	Olive Garden-style herb vinaigrette
Mushrooms → smoky bacon cues	Carrot ribbons → smoked-salmon cues	Chickpeas → tuna-salad cues
Frozen banana → chocolate soft-serve cues	Cauliflower → pepperoni-pizza cues	Apple & toasted oats → apple-pie cues
Carrots → smoky hot-dog cues	Vanilla grapes → cheesecake cues	Desert Planet: ember & citrus
Doom Mountain: cocoa-coffee fire	Shire Rain: woodland pantry	Wizard Tavern: butterbrew dust
Neon Noodle Glitch	Sea Temple: citrus & nori	Dragon Hoard: gold & cacao
Fairy Orchard: berry & pepper	Space Cantina: tamarind comet	Vampire Velvet: crimson roast
Eldritch Library: tea & porcini	Wonderland Tea Cake	Pirate Map: coffee & plantain spice
Monster Hunter: forest mustard	Solar Hero: pineapple & smoke	Lunar Library: sesame eclipse

Golden curry powder

A turmeric-led curry-powder family; a pantry convenience rather than a universal Indian formula.

earthy golden warm



Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

4 tsp	● Ground coriander
2 tsp	● Ground cumin
2 tsp	● Ground turmeric
1 tsp	● Ground ginger
½ tsp	● Ground fennel
¼ tsp	● Ground fenugreek
½ tsp	● Black pepper, ground
¼ tsp	● Cayenne

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES

Bloom gently in oil before adding liquid. Avoid scorching powders.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per 2 cups cooked vegetables or sauce.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Increase cayenne only after tasting; distinct regional curries use other combinations.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Check packaged powders for additives.

KEEPING IT

Keep airtight, cool and dark. Make small batches; use within 1–3 months for aroma.

Flavor reference: Kimberly Killebrew: curry powder
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Herby za'atar

A thyme-and-oregano interpretation of the herb, sumac and sesame family.

tart herbal toasty

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 2 tsp ● Dried thyme, crushed
- 1 tsp ● Dried oregano, crushed
- 2 tsp ● Ground sumac
- 2 tsp ● Toasted sesame seeds

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES

Scatter onto cooked vegetables or bread with olive oil.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per serving as a finishing sprinkle.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Actual za'atar herbs and ratios vary; thyme is a pantry adaptation, not the only authentic plant.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Sesame. Check sumac for added salt.

KEEPING IT

Airtight, cool and dark; use within 1 month for best seed aroma.

Flavor reference: Sylvia Fountaine: za'atar
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Baharat, warm paprika version

An aromatic pepper-and-sweet-spice blend with paprika in this version.

peppery warm rounded



Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

3 tsp	● Paprika
2 tsp	● Ground black pepper
2 tsp	● Ground cumin
2 tsp	● Ground coriander
1 tsp	● Ground cinnamon
½ tsp	● Ground allspice
¼ tsp	● Ground cardamom
⅛ tsp	● Ground cloves

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES

Use during cooking in grilled vegetables, meatballs or a rice sauce.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per 450 g / 1 lb food.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Baharat is a broad name; this is not a single regional standard.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Check spice labels.

KEEPING IT

Keep airtight, cool and dark. Make small batches; use within 1–3 months for aroma.

Flavor reference: Kimberly Killebrew: baharat

Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Ras el hanout, pantry edition

A deliberately short pantry interpretation of a much broader spice-shop family.

floral-warm earthy fragrant



Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tsp	● Ground ginger
2 tsp	● Ground coriander
1 tsp	● Ground cumin
1 tsp	● Ground cinnamon
1 tsp	● Ground turmeric
½ tsp	● Ground black pepper
½ tsp	● Ground allspice
¼ tsp	● Ground cardamom
⅛ tsp	● Ground nutmeg
⅛ tsp	● Ground cloves

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES

Add to a simmering tagine-style vegetable sauce or roast rub.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per 2 cups sauce.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Not a definitive formula: elaborate shop and family versions contain other spices.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Check labels.

KEEPING IT

Keep airtight, cool and dark. Make small batches; use within 1–3 months for aroma.

Flavor reference: Cuisine Marrakech: ras el hanout
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Berberere-inspired chili blend

A accessible chili-led interpretation; specialty seeds in traditional versions change the character.

chili-hot warm savory

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

4 tsp	● Sweet paprika
2 tsp	● Pure ground red chile
1 tsp	● Ground ginger
1 tsp	● Ground coriander
½ tsp	● Ground cumin
¼ tsp	● Ground fenugreek
¼ tsp	● Ground cardamom
¼ tsp	● Ground black pepper
⅛ tsp	● Ground cinnamon
⅛ tsp	● Ground cloves

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES

Cook into an onion-based stew; do not confuse this seasoning with a complete wat recipe.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.5 tsp per cup sauce; chile strength varies.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Korerima and besobela are not replicated by this simplified pantry mix.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Check labels; fenugreek may cross-react for some legume allergies.

KEEPING IT

Keep airtight, cool and dark. Make small batches; use within 1–3 months for aroma.

Flavor reference: Kimberly Killebrew: berbere
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Crunchy dukkah

A coarse nut-and-seed condiment rather than a smooth spice powder.

nutty crunchy toasty

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

4 tbsp	● Roasted hazelnuts
2 tbsp	● Toasted sesame seeds
1 tsp	● Ground coriander
1 tsp	● Ground cumin
¼ tsp	● Ground black pepper

Make it

1. Cool the roasted nuts and seeds completely.
2. Pulse the hazelnuts briefly to coarse crumbs; avoid making nut butter.
3. Stir in the seeds and spices. Leave a visibly crunchy texture.

WHERE IT SHINES

Sprinkle over soups, vegetables or bread dipped in oil.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Almonds or peanuts make different regional or household variations.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Tree nuts; sesame.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate airtight and use within 2 weeks for quality; freeze for longer keeping.

Flavor reference: Suzy Karadsheh: dukkah
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Harissa-style red chili paste

A small fresh batch built around red peppers, garlic and warm seeds.

hot garlicky earthy

heat & bite flavor carrier savory foundation flavor carrier carrier & balance earthy base earthy base earthy base

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

20 g	● Dried mild red chiles, stems and seeds removed
250 ml	● Boiling water for soaking
2 pieces	● Fresh garlic cloves, peeled
2 tbsp	● Olive oil
1 tbsp	● Lemon juice
1 tsp	● Ground coriander
½ tsp	● Ground caraway
½ tsp	● Ground cumin

Make it

1. Soak chiles in the boiling water for 20 minutes, then drain well; discard soaking water.
2. Blend drained chiles with the remaining ingredients to a paste.
3. Taste a tiny cooked portion before increasing chile heat.

WHERE IT SHINES

Stir a small spoon into vegetable sauces or oil-based marinades.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.25 tsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Chile varieties and seed combinations distinguish regional versions.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Check chile and spice labels.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly at 4°C / 40°F or colder; use within 4 days. Freeze spare portions. Acid or oil does not make this shelf-stable.

Flavor reference: Suzy Karadsheh: harissa
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Green chermoula

A fresh herb-garlic sauce with citrus and cumin.

green lemony savory

herbal lift herbal lift savory foundation carrier & balance flavor carrier earthy base earthy base body & color

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

½ cup	● Fresh cilantro, chopped
¼ cup	● Fresh parsley, chopped
2 pieces	● Fresh garlic cloves, peeled
2 tbsp	● Lemon juice
3 tbsp	● Olive oil
1 tsp	● Ground cumin
½ tsp	● Ground coriander
½ tsp	● Paprika

Make it

1. Wash and dry herbs; peel garlic.
2. Chop finely or pulse with all remaining ingredients until spoonable.
3. Reserve a clean portion for serving before using any as a raw-food marinade.

WHERE IT SHINES

Use on grilled vegetables or as a marinade; cook foods separately to their safe temperature.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tbsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Preserved lemon and red versions create other profiles.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No major allergen inherent; check labels.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly at 4°C / 40°F or colder; use within 4 days. Freeze spare portions. Acid or oil does not make this shelf-stable.

Flavor reference: Suzy Karadsheh: chermoula

Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Tabil-style coriander mix

Coriander with caraway and a restrained garlic-chile accent.

coriander-led earthy pungent

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

4 tsp	● Ground coriander
1 tsp	● Ground caraway
½ tsp	● Garlic powder
½ tsp	● Pure ground red chile

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES

Cook into vegetable or tomato-based stews.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per 2 cups sauce.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Some versions are fresh garlic pastes or include cumin.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Check labels.

KEEPING IT

Keep airtight, cool and dark. Make small batches; use within 1–3 months for aroma.

Flavor reference: L'île aux épices: tabel

Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Hawaij for soup

The savory soup family, separate from the sweeter coffee mixture.

cumin-led peppery golden

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

3 tsp	● Ground cumin
2 tsp	● Ground turmeric
1 tsp	● Ground black pepper
1 tsp	● Ground coriander
½ tsp	● Ground cardamom
⅛ tsp	● Ground cloves

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES

Simmer with soup, rice or vegetable stew.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.5 tsp per cup broth.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Coffee hawaij uses another profile; do not substitute this by name alone.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Check labels.

KEEPING IT

Keep airtight, cool and dark. Make small batches; use within 1–3 months for aroma.

Flavor reference: Foodish / ANU Museum: soup hawaij
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Advieh berenj-style rice spice

A gentle floral-warm accent for rice, distinct from stew spice mixtures.

floral sweet-spiced delicate

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tsp	● Ground cinnamon
1 tsp	● Ground cardamom
1 tsp	● Food-grade dried rose petals, finely ground
⅛ tsp	● Ground nutmeg

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES

Sprinkle between layers of cooked rice before gentle steaming.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.25 tsp per cup cooked rice.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Use culinary rose only; decorative petals can contain pesticides.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Check labels.

KEEPING IT

Keep airtight, cool and dark. Make small batches; use within 1–3 months for aroma.

Flavor reference: Homa: Persian rice spice
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Kabsa-style warm spice mix

A warm spice base for a rice dish whose full character also depends on tomato, onion and dried lime.

aromatic warm citrus-supporting

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tsp	● Ground coriander
1 tsp	● Ground cumin
½ tsp	● Ground cinnamon
½ tsp	● Ground cardamom
½ tsp	● Ground black pepper
½ tsp	● Ground turmeric
⅛ tsp	● Ground cloves

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES

Bloom briefly with onions before adding rice and cooking liquid.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per cup uncooked rice, following a complete rice recipe.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

A pierced culinary dried lime can be simmered and removed; this dry jar contains none.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Check labels.

KEEPING IT

Keep airtight, cool and dark. Make small batches; use within 1–3 months for aroma.

Flavor reference: Recipe creator: Kabsa spice variation
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Toum-style garlic emulsion

A small garlic-lemon emulsion inspired by toum; technique matters as much as the list.

garlicky bright creamy

savory foundation carrier & balance flavor carrier carrier & balance

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

30 g	● Fresh peeled garlic
25 ml	● Lemon juice
100 ml	● Neutral oil
15 ml	● Cold water

Make it

1. Puree garlic and half the lemon juice in a small processor that can reach this batch.
2. With the machine running, add oil in a very thin stream, alternating tiny additions of remaining lemon and water.
3. Stop when fluffy; if it breaks, serve as a garlic dressing instead of claiming a stable emulsion.

WHERE IT SHINES

Serve a clean spoonful with roasted vegetables or grilled food.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

A processor too large for the batch may fail; do not add raw egg to rescue this version.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Check oil labels; no egg or dairy in this recipe.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly at 4°C / 40°F or colder; use within 4 days. Freeze spare portions. Acid or oil does not make this shelf-stable.

Flavor reference: Suzy Karadsheh: toum
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Green zhug / schug

A fresh cilantro-chile condiment with warm spice accents.

herbal hot fragrant

herbal lift herbal lift heat & bite savory foundation flavor carrier earthy base earthy base warm aroma

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

½ cup	● Fresh cilantro, chopped
¼ cup	● Fresh parsley, chopped
1 piece	● Fresh green chile, stemmed
2 pieces	● Fresh garlic cloves, peeled
2 tbsp	● Olive oil
½ tsp	● Ground cumin
½ tsp	● Ground coriander
⅛ tsp	● Ground cardamom

Make it

1. Wash and dry herbs; remove some chile seeds for a milder first batch.
2. Pulse all ingredients into a coarse paste.
3. Taste a tiny amount with cooked food; add more gradually.

WHERE IT SHINES

Finish a cooked vegetable bowl or spoon beside bread.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.25 tsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Red and green versions vary; this is one cilantro-led interpretation.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Check spice labels.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly at 4°C / 40°F or colder; use within 4 days. Freeze spare portions. Acid or oil does not make this shelf-stable.

Flavor reference: Tori Avey: Yemenite schug
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Suya-style peanut seasoning

A peanut-chile-ginger interpretation using defatted peanut powder in place of kuli-kuli.

nutty hot gingery

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

3 tbsp	● Unsweetened defatted peanut powder
2 tsp	● Ground ginger
2 tsp	● Sweet paprika
1 tsp	● Pure ground red chile
1 tsp	● Onion powder
½ tsp	● Garlic powder
½ tsp	● Ground black pepper

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES

Combine with a little oil for a grill rub; serve some clean seasoning at the table.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per 150 g cooked food.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Defatted peanut powder approximates but does not duplicate ground kuli-kuli.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Peanuts; check powdered peanut ingredients.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate airtight; use within 2 weeks for quality. Follow peanut powder label limits.

Flavor reference: ChiChi: homemade suya spice
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Kelewele-style ginger coat

A gingery aromatic paste for the sweet-hot profile of plantain street food.

gingery sweet-supporting warm-hot

warm aroma savory foundation heat & bite warm aroma heat & bite liquid base

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tbsp	● Fresh ginger, grated
2 tbsp	● Fresh onion, chopped
¼ tsp	● Pure ground red chile
1/16 tsp	● Ground cloves
¼ tsp	● Ground black pepper
1 tbsp	● Water

Make it

1. Pound or blend into a smooth paste.
2. Toss with 300 g peeled plantain pieces.
3. Cook in a lightly oiled 200°C / 392°F oven about 20–30 minutes, turning, until tender and browned; this baked adaptation differs from fried kelewele.

WHERE IT SHINES

Flavor ripe plantains.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Use the batch for 300 g plantain, then adjust next time.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Calabash nutmeg can be characteristic; the tiny clove amount here keeps the pantry version restrained.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Check spice labels.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly at 4°C / 40°F or colder; use within 4 days. Freeze spare portions. Acid or oil does not make this shelf-stable.

Flavor reference: Imma: kelewele
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Nokoss-style aromatic base

A fresh pepper-onion-garlic base; household versions differ by dish.

savory green peppery

herbal lift heat & bite savory foundation savory foundation allium freshness heat & bite liquid base

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 1/4 cup ● Fresh parsley, chopped
- 1/4 cup ● Fresh green bell pepper, chopped
- 1/4 cup ● Fresh onion, chopped
- 3 pieces ● Fresh garlic cloves, peeled
- 2 tbsp ● Fresh scallions, chopped
- 1/2 tsp ● Ground black pepper
- 1 tbsp ● Water

Make it

1. Wash vegetables and herbs; dry before chopping.
2. Blend coarsely with the water.
3. Cook 1–2 tbsp in a little oil until aromatic before building a sauce.

WHERE IT SHINES

Use as an aromatic starting base in a stew or rice dish.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tbsp per 2 cups sauce.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Some versions include chile, bouillon or fermented ingredients; none is implied here.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No major allergen inherent; check packaged pepper.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly at 4°C / 40°F or colder; use within 4 days. Freeze spare portions. Acid or oil does not make this shelf-stable.

Flavor reference: Tabou en cuisine: nokoss
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Cameroonian green spices

A celery-parsley-basil aromatic base inspired by green seasoning.

green savory herbal

savory foundation herbal lift herbal lift savory foundation warm aroma savory foundation liquid base

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

¼ cup	● Fresh celery, chopped
¼ cup	● Fresh parsley, chopped
¼ cup	● Fresh basil leaves
2 pieces	● Fresh garlic cloves, peeled
1 tsp	● Fresh ginger, grated
2 tbsp	● Fresh onion, chopped
1 tbsp	● Water

Make it

1. Wash and dry greens.
2. Blend into a coarse paste with the remaining ingredients.
3. Cook a small spoonful in oil before adding vegetables or sauce liquid.

WHERE IT SHINES

Build a simmered sauce or marinade.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tbsp per 450 g food.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Different households add leeks, scallions and pepper; this does not represent all Cameroonian dishes.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Celery.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly at 4°C / 40°F or colder; use within 4 days. Freeze spare portions. Acid or oil does not make this shelf-stable.

Flavor reference: Precious: green seasoning

Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Maafe-inspired peanut-tomato base

A flavor concentrate for a groundnut-style sauce, not a complete traditional stew.

nutty savory rounded

nutty body concentrated tomato savory foundation savory foundation flavor carrier liquid base warm aroma heat & bite

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tbsp	● Unsweetened smooth peanut butter
1 tbsp	● Tomato paste
¼ cup	● Fresh onion, finely chopped
1 piece	● Fresh garlic cloves, peeled and minced
1 tsp	● Neutral oil
½ cup	● Water
¼ tsp	● Ground ginger
1/16 tsp	● Cayenne

Make it

1. Soften onion in the oil over medium-low heat for 5 minutes.
2. Add minced garlic and tomato paste; stir for 1 minute.
3. Whisk in peanut butter, water and spices; simmer gently 8–10 minutes, stirring.

WHERE IT SHINES

Spoon into a separately cooked vegetable stew and thin to the desired consistency.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tbsp base per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Groundnut sauces vary widely; peanut butter and tomato form only one family.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Peanuts.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly at 4°C / 40°F or colder; use within 4 days. Freeze spare portions. Acid or oil does not make this shelf-stable.

Flavor reference: Imma: maafe

Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Braai-style coriander rub

A coriander-paprika grill rub inspired by braai cooking, not a single national spice standard.

toasty peppery savory



Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

3 tsp	● Ground coriander
2 tsp	● Sweet paprika
1 tsp	● Ground black pepper
1 tsp	● Garlic powder
1 tsp	● Onion powder
½ tsp	● Dried thyme
⅛ tsp	● Cayenne

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES

Coat vegetables lightly with oil, add rub and grill; avoid burning spices.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per 450 g food.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Braai names a cooking and gathering tradition; seasoning is individual.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Check labels.

KEEPING IT

Keep airtight, cool and dark. Make small batches; use within 1–3 months for aroma.

Flavor reference: Jan Braai: recipe traditions

Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

East African pilau-style masala

A cumin-led aromatic mix for rice cooking.

toasty warm aromatic

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

3 tsp	● Ground cumin
1 tsp	● Ground coriander
¾ tsp	● Ground cardamom
½ tsp	● Ground cinnamon
½ tsp	● Ground black pepper
⅛ tsp	● Ground cloves

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES

Bloom briefly with onions before adding rice and water according to a complete rice recipe.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per cup uncooked rice.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Whole-spice and ground-spice recipes differ by household and coast.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Check labels.

KEEPING IT

Keep airtight, cool and dark. Make small batches; use within 1–3 months for aroma.

Flavor reference: Chef Lola: East African pilau
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Nyama choma-style lemon garlic marinade

A restrained citrus-garlic marinade for grilled food rather than an asserted canonical rub.

citrus garlicky peppery

carrier & balance flavor carrier savory foundation warm aroma heat & bite earthy base

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tbsp	● Lemon juice
1 tbsp	● Neutral oil
2 pieces	● Fresh garlic cloves, minced
1 tsp	● Fresh ginger, grated
½ tsp	● Ground black pepper
¼ tsp	● Ground cumin

Make it

1. Whisk everything together in a clean bowl.
2. Use 2 tbsp per 450 g vegetables or other grill ingredients; refrigerate while marinating.
3. Keep serving sauce separate before contact with raw animal food; discard used raw-food marinade.

WHERE IT SHINES

Grill vegetables or season foods following a full safe cooking recipe.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tbsp per 450 g food.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Some nyama choma relies largely on the meat, fire and salt; this is a lemon-garlic home variation.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No major allergen inherent; check labels.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly at 4°C / 40°F or colder; use within 4 days. Freeze spare portions. Acid or oil does not make this shelf-stable.

Flavor reference: We Eat At Last — The Ultimate Nyama Choma Recipe; marinade family reference
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Xawaash, ground pantry version

An aromatic cumin-coriander blend with turmeric and warm whole-spice character.

aromatic earthy warm

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

3 tsp	● Ground cumin
3 tsp	● Ground coriander
1 tsp	● Ground turmeric
¾ tsp	● Ground black pepper
½ tsp	● Ground cinnamon
½ tsp	● Ground cardamom
⅛ tsp	● Ground cloves

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES

Cook a small spoon into a stew or rice base.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.5 tsp per cup sauce.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Freshly toasted whole spices produce a different intensity from this ground-spice shortcut.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Check labels.

KEEPING IT

Keep airtight, cool and dark. Make small batches; use within 1–3 months for aroma.

Flavor reference: Xawaash: Somali spice mix
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Sakay-style chili ginger condiment

A deliberately tiny hot-chile condiment batch; strength depends on the pepper.

hot gingery sharp

heat & bite warm aroma savory foundation carrier & balance flavor carrier

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 15 g ● Fresh red chile, stemmed
- 2 tsp ● Fresh ginger, grated
- 1 piece ● Fresh garlic cloves, peeled
- 2 tsp ● Lemon juice
- 1 tsp ● Neutral oil

Make it

1. Use gloves when handling hot chiles; avoid touching eyes.
2. Blend all ingredients into a paste.
3. Sample a pinhead-sized amount with cooked food, then adjust usage.

WHERE IT SHINES

Serve a tiny clean spoon beside rice or cooked dishes.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with less than 0.125 tsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Peanut versions exist; this base omits peanuts and is not a claim about every household.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No major allergen inherent; check oil labels.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly at 4°C / 40°F or colder; use within 4 days. Freeze spare portions. Acid or oil does not make this shelf-stable.

Flavor reference: MadaMagazine: Malagasy chili condiment variation
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Cajun paprika & pepper rub

A paprika-forward Louisiana-inspired seasoning; Cajun cooking also depends on aromatics, browning and technique.

peppery earthy savory

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

3 tsp	● Sweet paprika
2 tsp	● Garlic powder
1 tsp	● Onion powder
1 tsp	● Ground black pepper
1 tsp	● Dried thyme
¼ tsp	● Cayenne powder
½ tsp	● Dried oregano

Make it

1. Measure all dry ingredients with level spoons.
2. Crush coarse herbs between your fingers; stir everything until the color and texture are uniform.
3. Transfer to a labeled airtight jar. Start with the suggested dose and adjust after cooking.

WHERE IT SHINES

Roasted potatoes, sautéed mushrooms or beans.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per 450 g vegetables, plus 1 tbsp oil; salt separately if desired.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

For extra heat increase cayenne to 0.5 tsp per batch.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No major allergens intentionally added; check ingredient labels and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Airtight container in a cool, dark, dry cupboard; best quality within 1–3 months. Use a clean, dry spoon.

Flavor reference: Emeril's Essence Creole Seasoning — flavor reference
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Creole garden-herb seasoning

A thyme-and-oregano leaning cousin to the paprika rub; an original ratio, not a categorical rule distinguishing all Cajun and Creole kitchens.

herbal garlicky warm



Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 2 tsp ● Sweet paprika
- 2 tsp ● Garlic powder
- 1 ½ tsp ● Onion powder
- 1 ½ tsp ● Dried oregano
- 1 ½ tsp ● Dried thyme
- ¾ tsp ● Ground black pepper
- ⅛ tsp ● Cayenne powder

Make it

1. Measure all dry ingredients with level spoons.
2. Crush coarse herbs between your fingers; stir everything until the color and texture are uniform.
3. Transfer to a labeled airtight jar. Start with the suggested dose and adjust after cooking.

WHERE IT SHINES

Tomato-based bean stews and roasted squash.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per 2 cups cooked beans or stew; simmer 10 minutes and taste.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Add 0.5 tsp dried basil for a personal garden-herb variation.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No major allergens intentionally added; check ingredient labels and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Airtight container in a cool, dark, dry cupboard; best quality within 1–3 months. Use a clean, dry spoon.

Flavor reference: Emeril's Essence Creole Seasoning — flavor reference
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Memphis-style sweet paprika BBQ dust

An original barbecue rub combining paprika, brown sugar and mustard; no claim to a restaurant's formula.

sweet-smoky mustardy peppery



Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

3 tsp	● Sweet paprika
1 tsp	● Smoked paprika
3 tsp	● Light brown sugar
1 tsp	● Mustard powder
1 tsp	● Garlic powder
½ tsp	● Ground cumin
½ tsp	● Ground black pepper
⅛ tsp	● Cayenne powder

Make it

1. Break up any sugar lumps with a fork.
2. Stir all measured ingredients until evenly blended.
3. Apply lightly before roasting; sugar scorches over very high direct heat.

WHERE IT SHINES

Roasted cauliflower or baked beans.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tsp per 450 g cauliflower plus 1 tbsp oil; roast at 200°C/400°F.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

For a less sweet batch halve the brown sugar.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Mustard; check all labels and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Airtight container in a cool, dark, dry cupboard; best quality within 1–3 months. Use a clean, dry spoon.

Flavor reference: Lawry's Memphis Style Barbecue Rub — official ingredient/flavor reference

Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Chesapeake celery-spice dust · Old Bay-inspired

Inspired by the publicly listed celery, pepper and paprika profile. Added mustard, bay and clove are this guide's choices, not a verified proprietary formula.

celery-bright peppery warm



Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- | | |
|----------|--------------------------------|
| 2 tsp | ● Ground celery seed |
| 2 tsp | ● Sweet paprika |
| ¾ tsp | ● Ground black pepper |
| ¾ tsp | ● Mustard powder |
| ¼ tsp | ● Finely ground dried bay leaf |
| ⅛ tsp | ● Cayenne powder |
| 1/16 tsp | ● Ground cloves |

Make it

1. Measure all dry ingredients with level spoons.
2. Crush coarse herbs between your fingers; stir everything until the color and texture are uniform.
3. Transfer to a labeled airtight jar. Start with the suggested dose and adjust after cooking.

WHERE IT SHINES

Oven fries, corn or roasted mushrooms.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.5 tsp per 2 cups cooked vegetables; salt separately.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Omit clove for a cleaner celery-pepper version.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Celery and mustard; check labels and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Airtight container in a cool, dark, dry cupboard; best quality within 1–3 months. Use a clean, dry spoon.

Flavor reference: OLD BAY Seasoning — official public ingredients
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

American sage & thyme roast seasoning

Herb-led poultry-seasoning inspiration that also works on vegetables and bread stuffing.

woody sage-rich peppery

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 2 tsp ● Rubbed dried sage
- 1 ½ tsp ● Dried thyme
- 1 tsp ● Dried marjoram
- ½ tsp ● Crushed dried rosemary
- ½ tsp ● Ground black pepper
- ⅛ tsp ● Ground nutmeg

Make it

1. Measure all dry ingredients with level spoons.
2. Crush coarse herbs between your fingers; stir everything until the color and texture are uniform.
3. Transfer to a labeled airtight jar. Start with the suggested dose and adjust after cooking.

WHERE IT SHINES

Mushroom gravy, roasted roots or stuffing.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.5 tsp per 2 cups cooked vegetables or gravy.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Add 0.5 tsp garlic powder for a savory personal variation.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No major allergens intentionally added; check ingredient labels and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Airtight container in a cool, dark, dry cupboard; best quality within 1–3 months. Use a clean, dry spoon.

Flavor reference: McCormick Poultry Seasoning – official herb reference
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Montréal-style cracked pepper & coriander

A coarse Canadian steak-spice interpretation with dill and garlic; salt kept separate.

peppery coriander-bright dill-fragrant

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tsp	● Coarsely cracked black pepper
1 ½ tsp	● Crushed coriander seeds
1 ½ tsp	● Garlic powder
1 tsp	● Dill seed, lightly crushed
1 tsp	● Sweet paprika
¼ tsp	● Crushed red chile flakes

Make it

1. Crack pepper, coriander and dill with a mortar; leave some texture.
2. Stir in the remaining dry ingredients.
3. Jar and label; press onto an oiled surface rather than leaving loose powder in a hot pan.

WHERE IT SHINES

Grilled portobello mushrooms or roasted carrots.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per 450 g vegetables plus 1 tbsp oil.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Replace half the dill seed with mustard seed for a personal variation; mustard becomes an allergen.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No major allergens in base; optional mustard; check labels.

KEEPING IT

Airtight container in a cool, dark, dry cupboard; best quality within 1–3 months. Use a clean, dry spoon.

Flavor reference: Homemade Montreal Steak Spice — Barry C. Parsons
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Mexican-American chile & oregano taco blend

An adaptable taco seasoning rather than a spice profile for all Mexican cuisines. Uses pure ground ancho, not an unspecified commercial chili-powder mix.

chile-fruity earthy herbal



Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

3 tsp	● Pure ground ancho chile
1 tsp	● Ground cumin
1 tsp	● Garlic powder
¾ tsp	● Onion powder
1 tsp	● Dried Mexican oregano
1 tsp	● Sweet paprika
¼ tsp	● Ground black pepper

Make it

1. Measure all dry ingredients with level spoons.
2. Crush coarse herbs between your fingers; stir everything until the color and texture are uniform.
3. Transfer to a labeled airtight jar. Start with the suggested dose and adjust after cooking.

WHERE IT SHINES

Bean taco filling and sautéed peppers.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tsp per 2 cups cooked beans; stir in 2 tbsp water and simmer 5 minutes.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Use 1 tsp chipotle powder in place of 1 tsp ancho for smoke and more heat.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No major allergens intentionally added; check ingredient labels and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Airtight container in a cool, dark, dry cupboard; best quality within 1–3 months. Use a clean, dry spoon.

Flavor reference: Homemade Taco Seasoning — Isabel Orozco-Moore
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Mexican ancho-guajillo adobo base

A chile-and-vinegar cooking paste, distinct from Puerto Rican dry adobo and Filipino adobo dishes.

fruity-chile tart warm

dark fruity body bright chile body rehydration savory base tartness earthiness herb aroma warm accent

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

20 g	● Dried ancho chiles, stemmed and seeded
15 g	● Dried guajillo chiles, stemmed and seeded
2 cup	● Water for soaking
12 g	● Fresh garlic, peeled
2 tbsp	● White vinegar
½ tsp	● Ground cumin
1 tsp	● Dried Mexican oregano
1/16 tsp	● Ground cloves

Make it

1. Toast the chiles in a dry skillet over medium heat for 15–20 seconds per side, until fragrant; do not blacken.
2. Cover with the measured hot water; soak 20 minutes, then drain, keeping 0.5 cup soaking liquid.
3. Blend softened chiles with garlic, vinegar, spices and the reserved 0.5 cup liquid until smooth.
4. Use as a cooking base and refrigerate promptly.

WHERE IT SHINES

Simmered beans, mushrooms or roasted vegetable sauce.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tbsp per 2 cups cooked beans; simmer 10 minutes.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Use 0.125 tsp cinnamon instead of clove for another home variation.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No major allergens intentionally added; check ingredient labels and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at or below 4°C/40°F; use within 4 days. Freeze portions for longer keeping. Citrus or vinegar does not make this shelf-stable.

Flavor reference: Mexican Adobo Sauce — Mamá Maggie's Kitchen
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Yucatán-style achiote recado rojo

Annatto is the central ingredient; sour orange and warm spices make an orange-red cooking paste.

earthy-annatto citrus-tart warm

red color and earthy body savory base acid and citrus herbal note earthiness pepper bite warm spice warm accent

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tbsp	● Ground annatto / achiote
10 g	● Fresh garlic, peeled
4 tbsp	● Fresh sour orange juice
1 tsp	● Dried Mexican oregano
½ tsp	● Ground cumin
½ tsp	● Ground black pepper
¼ tsp	● Ground allspice
1/16 tsp	● Ground cloves

Make it

1. Mash peeled garlic in a mortar.
2. Mix ground spices with the sour orange juice.
3. Pound or blend with garlic to a thick, spreadable paste.

WHERE IT SHINES

Roasted squash, mushrooms or a vegetable braise.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tbsp per 450 g vegetables plus 1 tbsp oil.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

If sour orange is unavailable replace the 4 tbsp with 3 tbsp orange juice plus 1 tbsp lime juice; label the substitution.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No major allergens intentionally added; check ingredient labels and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at or below 4°C/40°F; use within 4 days. Freeze portions for longer keeping. Citrus or vinegar does not make this shelf-stable.

Flavor reference: Recado Rojo — Los Dos cooking school

Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Puerto Rican-style annatto sazón

A warm annatto-led dry blend for color and aroma. Sazón can mean a different preparation in other countries.

earthy garlicky herbal

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tsp	● Ground annatto / achiote
1 ½ tsp	● Ground cumin
1 ½ tsp	● Garlic powder
1 tsp	● Ground coriander
¾ tsp	● Dried oregano
¼ tsp	● Ground black pepper

Make it

1. Measure all dry ingredients with level spoons.
2. Crush coarse herbs between your fingers; stir everything until the color and texture are uniform.
3. Transfer to a labeled airtight jar. Start with the suggested dose and adjust after cooking.

WHERE IT SHINES

Rice, beans and vegetable stews.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per 2 cups cooked beans or 1 cup uncooked rice added before cooking.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

For a turmeric substitution use 0.5 tsp turmeric in place of annatto; the flavor changes.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No major allergens intentionally added; check ingredient labels and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Airtight container in a cool, dark, dry cupboard; best quality within 1–3 months. Use a clean, dry spoon.

Flavor reference: 5 Minute DIY Sazon Seasoning — Salima Benkhalti
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Puerto Rican-style adobo seco

Garlic, oregano and pepper in a dry everyday seasoning; this original batch leaves salt separate.

garlicky oregano-fragrant peppery

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

3 tsp	● Garlic powder
1 ½ tsp	● Onion powder
1 ½ tsp	● Dried oregano
¾ tsp	● Ground black pepper
½ tsp	● Ground cumin
⅛ tsp	● Ground turmeric

Make it

1. Measure all dry ingredients with level spoons.
2. Crush coarse herbs between your fingers; stir everything until the color and texture are uniform.
3. Transfer to a labeled airtight jar. Start with the suggested dose and adjust after cooking.

WHERE IT SHINES

Roasted vegetables, bean soups or a dry coating.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per 450 g vegetables plus 1 tbsp oil.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Omit turmeric for a garlic-oregano focused batch.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No major allergens intentionally added; check ingredient labels and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Airtight container in a cool, dark, dry cupboard; best quality within 1–3 months. Use a clean, dry spoon.

Flavor reference: 5 Minute DIY Adobo Spice Seasoning — Salima's Kitchen
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Puerto Rican green sofrito / recaíto

A fresh pepper, onion and culantro cooking base. Household formulas and use of the names differ.

green-herbal garlicky sweet-pepper

aromatic base green sweetness sweet pepper aroma savory base green herb pungent herb blending aid

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

100 g	● Fresh yellow onion, peeled and chopped
100 g	● Fresh green bell pepper, seeded
60 g	● Fresh ají dulce peppers, seeded
15 g	● Fresh garlic, peeled
20 g	● Fresh cilantro, washed
8 g	● Fresh culantro / recaio, washed
1 tbsp	● Water

Make it

1. Verify ají dulce are sweet peppers rather than similar-looking hot habaneros; wash, trim and chop all produce.
2. Pulse peppers and onion with garlic in a food processor.
3. Add herbs and measured water; pulse to a fine, moist paste.
4. Cook a portion in the pan as the aromatic beginning of a dish; refrigerate the rest promptly.

WHERE IT SHINES

Rice dishes, stewed beans and vegetable soups.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tbsp per 2 cups beans; sauté the portion in 1 tbsp oil for 3–5 minutes before adding beans.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Use 60 g red bell pepper if ají dulce is unavailable; replace 8 g culantro with 15 g cilantro and note the changed aroma.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No major allergens intentionally added; check labels and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at or below 4°C/40°F; use within 4 days. Freeze portions for longer keeping. Citrus or vinegar does not make this shelf-stable.

Flavor reference: Recaito (Puerto Rican Sofrito) — The Noshery
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Cuban-style garlic-citrus mojo

A tart garlic sauce inspired by mojo criollo; sour orange is preferred.

citrus-tart garlicky oregano-fragrant

tart citrus savory backbone aromatic sweetness roundness herb note bite

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

½ cup	● Fresh sour orange juice
15 g	● Fresh garlic, peeled and minced
2 tbsp	● Fresh white onion, finely minced
2 tbsp	● Olive oil
¾ tsp	● Dried oregano
¼ tsp	● Ground black pepper

Make it

1. Mash garlic in a mortar until finely crushed.
2. Whisk garlic, onion, citrus, oregano and pepper together.
3. Whisk in oil; shake before each use and refrigerate promptly.

WHERE IT SHINES

Cooked yuca, beans or grilled vegetables.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tbsp per cup cooked vegetables.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Replace 0.5 cup sour orange juice with 6 tbsp orange juice plus 2 tbsp lime juice for a home substitute.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No major allergens intentionally added; check labels and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at or below 4°C/40°F; use within 4 days. Freeze portions for longer keeping. Citrus or vinegar does not make this shelf-stable.

Flavor reference: Authentic Cuban Mojo Marinade — Jamie Silva
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Dominican-style fresh sazón

A fresh aromatic base; Dominican sazón is not automatically the same thing as Puerto Rican dry sazón.

pepper-herbal garlicky oregano-fragrant

aromatic base pepper sweetness savory base green herb herbal backbone tartness blending aid

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- | | |
|--------|-----------------------------------|
| 100 g | ● Fresh yellow onion, peeled |
| 100 g | ● Fresh green bell pepper, seeded |
| 15 g | ● Fresh garlic, peeled |
| 20 g | ● Fresh cilantro, washed |
| 1 tsp | ● Dried Dominican oregano |
| 2 tbsp | ● White vinegar |
| 1 tbsp | ● Water |

Make it

1. Wash herbs and peppers; peel onion and garlic.
2. Chop produce, then pulse in a food processor with vinegar and water.
3. Mix in oregano and pulse again; transfer to a clean container and refrigerate promptly.

WHERE IT SHINES Stewed beans and vegetable braises.	STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE Start with 2 tbsp per 2 cups beans; sauté in 1 tbsp oil for 3 minutes first.
VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS Use ordinary dried oregano if Dominican oregano is unavailable; its aroma differs.	
ALLERGENS & LABELS No major allergens intentionally added; check ingredient labels and cross-contact.	KEEPING IT Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at or below 4°C/40°F; use within 4 days. Freeze portions for longer keeping. Citrus or vinegar does not make this shelf-stable.

Flavor reference: Sazón Dominicano — Dominican Cooking
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Jamaican-inspired jerk paste

Allspice, thyme and Scotch bonnet are the guiding flavors; jerk also refers to a cooking tradition, not just a spice jar.

allspice-warm thyme-fragrant fiery

green allium savory base fresh heat herbal backbone signature warm aroma intense chile heat tartness fruity balance

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

40 g	● Fresh scallions, trimmed
10 g	● Fresh garlic, peeled
8 g	● Fresh ginger, peeled
1 tbsp	● Fresh thyme leaves
1 ½ tsp	● Ground allspice
¼ pieces	● Fresh Scotch bonnet chile, stem removed
2 tbsp	● Lime juice
2 tbsp	● Orange juice
1 tsp	● Brown sugar
1 tbsp	● Neutral oil
⅛ tsp	● Ground cinnamon

Make it

1. Wear gloves to prepare the Scotch bonnet; avoid touching eyes. Start with only the measured quarter pepper.
2. Roughly chop scallions, garlic and ginger.
3. Blend all ingredients into a paste; refrigerate promptly.
4. Brush a thin layer onto vegetables before roasting; avoid scorching the sugar.

WHERE IT SHINES

Roasted mushrooms, squash or grilled vegetables.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tbsp per 450 g vegetables; chile heat varies greatly.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Use half the measured Scotch bonnet for a gentler first batch; it can still be hot.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No major allergens intentionally added; check ingredient labels and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at or below 4°C/40°F; use within 4 days. Freeze portions for longer keeping. Citrus or vinegar does not make this shelf-stable.

Flavor reference: The ONLY Jerk Marinade YOU Need — Chris De La Rosa, creator's ingredient list
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Trinidad-style green seasoning

A green aromatic base centered on culantro/shado beni, scallion and thyme.

green-herbal garlicky pepper-sweet

pungent green aroma green lift allium base savory depth herb backbone vegetal aroma sweet pepper aroma blending aid

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

15 g	● Fresh culantro / shado beni, washed
15 g	● Fresh cilantro, washed
40 g	● Fresh scallions, trimmed
15 g	● Fresh garlic, peeled
1 tbsp	● Fresh thyme leaves
30 g	● Fresh celery with leaves, chopped
40 g	● Fresh Caribbean pimento seasoning peppers, seeded
2 tbsp	● Water

Make it

1. Wash herbs and vegetables; peel garlic. Use sweet seasoning peppers, not allspice berries.
2. Roughly chop produce.
3. Blend with the measured water to a thick paste; refrigerate promptly.

WHERE IT SHINES

Vegetable curry, stews and beans.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tbsp per 2 cups cooked beans; sauté in 1 tbsp oil for 3 minutes.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Replace 15 g culantro with 25 g cilantro and pimento peppers with 40 g Cubanelle pepper if unavailable; the profile changes.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Celery; check labels and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at or below 4°C/40°F; use within 4 days. Freeze portions for longer keeping. Citrus or vinegar does not make this shelf-stable.

Flavor reference: Trinidad Green Seasoning — Chris De La Rosa
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Haitian-inspired epis

A fresh garlic, pepper and herb foundation; this home version emphasizes parsley and thyme.

parsley-bright garlicky pepper-sweet

green backbone allium base pepper body aromatic sweetness savory depth herb depth tartness carrier

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

25 g	● Fresh parsley, washed
35 g	● Fresh scallions, trimmed
100 g	● Fresh green bell pepper, seeded
60 g	● Fresh yellow onion, peeled
15 g	● Fresh garlic, peeled
1 tsp	● Fresh thyme leaves
2 tbsp	● Lime juice
1 tbsp	● Olive oil
¼ tsp	● Ground black pepper

Make it

1. Wash, trim and roughly chop the vegetables and herbs.
2. Pulse onion, pepper and garlic in a food processor.
3. Add parsley, scallions, thyme, lime, oil and black pepper; blend to a thick paste and refrigerate promptly.

WHERE IT SHINES

Vegetable stews, beans and rice dishes.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tbsp per 2 cups stew; sauté in 1 tbsp oil for 3 minutes first.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

For heat, blend in 0.125 fresh Scotch bonnet pepper, wearing gloves; heat varies.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No major allergens intentionally added; check labels and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at or below 4°C/40°F; use within 4 days. Freeze portions for longer keeping. Citrus or vinegar does not make this shelf-stable.

Flavor reference: Haitian Epis — Caribbean Green Living
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Bahia-inspired tempero baiano

A warm cumin-coriander seasoning interpretation; it does not stand in for the whole of Bahia's diverse cooking.

earthy coriander-bright peppery



Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tsp	● Ground cumin
1 ½ tsp	● Ground coriander
1 ½ tsp	● Sweet paprika
½ tsp	● Ground turmeric
¾ tsp	● Ground black pepper
1 tsp	● Dried oregano
1 tsp	● Garlic powder
¼ tsp	● Crushed red chile flakes

Make it

1. Measure all dry ingredients with level spoons.
2. Crush coarse herbs between your fingers; stir everything until the color and texture are uniform.
3. Transfer to a labeled airtight jar. Start with the suggested dose and adjust after cooking.

WHERE IT SHINES

Roasted pumpkin, beans and vegetable stews.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per 2 cups cooked beans or vegetables.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

For a more herbaceous personal variation add 0.5 tsp dried basil.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No major allergens intentionally added; check labels and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Airtight container in a cool, dark, dry cupboard; best quality within 1–3 months. Use a clean, dry spoon.

Flavor reference: Tempero Baiano — Adriana Tenchini

Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Argentine-style parsley chimichurri

A chopped herb-vinegar sauce for grilled foods; this fresh parsley version is one household-style interpretation.

herbal vinegar-bright garlicky

herb body savory base herb depth tartness carrier gentle heat bite

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

½ cup	● Fresh parsley, finely chopped
8 g	● Fresh garlic, peeled and minced
1 tsp	● Dried oregano
2 tbsp	● Red wine vinegar
4 tbsp	● Olive oil
¼ tsp	● Crushed red chile flakes
¼ tsp	● Ground black pepper

Make it

1. Wash and dry parsley, then chop finely by hand.
2. Stir garlic, oregano, vinegar, pepper and chile into the parsley.
3. Mix in oil, rest 15 minutes in the refrigerator, then stir before using.

WHERE IT SHINES

Grilled vegetables, mushrooms or bean salads.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tbsp per cup cooked vegetables.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Use neutral oil instead of olive oil for a lighter carrier; keep the parsley-vinegar character.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Wine vinegar may contain sulfites; check labels and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at or below 4°C/40°F; use within 4 days. Freeze portions for longer keeping. Citrus or vinegar does not make this shelf-stable.

Flavor reference: Cómo hacer chimichurri casero — Paulina Cocina
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Peruvian-inspired ají amarillo aderezo

A cooked onion-garlic-yellow-chile base. Use genuine ají amarillo paste; generic hot sauce changes the flavor.

fruity-chile savory earthy

aromatic base savory depth fruity yellow chile cooking carrier earthy accent moisture

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 100 g ● Fresh red onion, peeled and finely chopped
- 10 g ● Fresh garlic, peeled and minced
- 3 tbsp ● Ají amarillo paste
- 1 ½ tbsp ● Neutral oil
- ¼ tsp ● Ground cumin
- 2 tbsp ● Water

Make it

1. Warm oil in a skillet over medium-low heat; soften the onion for 8–10 minutes without burning.
2. Add garlic and cumin; stir for 30 seconds.
3. Stir in ají paste and measured water; cook gently for 5–7 minutes until thick.
4. Cool in a shallow covered container and refrigerate promptly, within 2 hours.

WHERE IT SHINES

Vegetable braises, beans or a cooking base for a separate sauce.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tbsp per 2 cups cooked beans; simmer together 5 minutes.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Use ají panca paste for a darker chile version, explicitly labeled as a variation.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Check jarred chile paste for allergens, salt and cross-contact; no major allergens added to the base.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at or below 4°C/40°F; use within 4 days. Freeze portions for longer keeping. Citrus or vinegar does not make this shelf-stable.

Flavor reference: How to Make Peruvian Aji Amarillo Paste — Lorena Salinas, flavor ingredient reference
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Merkén-inspired smoky chile & coriander

A pantry approximation only. Authentic merkén relies on smoked cacho de cabra chile; smoked paprika and cayenne do not reproduce it exactly.

smoky chile-warm coriander-bright

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

3 tsp	● Smoked paprika
½ tsp	● Cayenne powder
1 tsp	● Ground coriander

Make it

1. Measure all dry ingredients with level spoons.
2. Crush coarse herbs between your fingers; stir everything until the color and texture are uniform.
3. Transfer to a labeled airtight jar. Start with the suggested dose and adjust after cooking.

WHERE IT SHINES

Roasted potatoes, grilled squash or a finishing sprinkle.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.25 tsp per cup cooked vegetables.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

If genuine smoked cacho de cabra powder is available, replace the paprika and cayenne with 3.5 tsp of it; it will differ in heat.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No major allergens intentionally added; check labels and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Airtight container in a cool, dark, dry cupboard; best quality within 1–3 months. Use a clean, dry spoon.

Flavor reference: Cacho Cabra — Chilean producer's description of authentic merkén
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Colombian-style tomato-scallion hogao

A gently cooked tomato and scallion base; flavors vary by household and region.

tomato-sweet allium-savory soft-herbal

juicy body allium backbone savory accent cooking carrier herbal lift bite

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

250 g	● Fresh ripe tomatoes, chopped
75 g	● Fresh scallions, trimmed and chopped
5 g	● Fresh garlic, peeled and minced
1 tbsp	● Neutral oil
1 tbsp	● Fresh cilantro, chopped
1⁄8 tsp	● Ground black pepper

Make it

1. Warm oil over medium-low heat; soften scallions for 5 minutes.
2. Add garlic for 30 seconds, then tomatoes and black pepper.
3. Cook gently 12–15 minutes, stirring, until soft and thick; stir in cilantro.
4. Cool in a shallow container and refrigerate promptly, within 2 hours.

WHERE IT SHINES

Arepas, potatoes or cooked beans.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tbsp per arepa or cup cooked vegetables.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Omit garlic for a simpler tomato-and-scallion version.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No major allergens intentionally added; check labels and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at or below 4°C/40°F; use within 4 days. Freeze portions for longer keeping. Citrus or vinegar does not make this shelf-stable.

Flavor reference: Hogao — My Colombian Cocina
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Bolivian-style locoto llajua

Fresh tomato, locoto and quirquiña ground into a table sauce. Substitutions are approximations.

tomato-fresh fiery herbal

juicy base chile heat distinctive green aroma

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 200 g ● Fresh ripe tomato, chopped
- ¼ pieces ● Fresh locoto / rocoto pepper, stemmed and seeded
- 1 tbsp ● Fresh quirquiña leaves, washed

Make it

1. Wear gloves to handle locoto; begin with a quarter pepper and remove seeds and membranes.
2. Grind tomato and chile in a mortar, or pulse briefly in a blender.
3. Add quirquiña and pulse or grind to a textured sauce; serve promptly or refrigerate.

WHERE IT SHINES

A small table condiment for potatoes, beans or vegetable empanadas.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.5 tsp per serving; locoto heat varies.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

If locoto and quirquiña are unavailable, use 0.25 jalapeño plus 1 tbsp cilantro; label it llajua-inspired, not an equivalent.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No major allergens intentionally added; check labels and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at or below 4°C/40°F; use within 4 days. Freeze portions for longer keeping. Citrus or vinegar does not make this shelf-stable.

Flavor reference: Llajwa (Spicy Bolivian Salsa) — Bolivian Cookbook
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Ecuadorian-style ají criollo

A fresh chile, cilantro, garlic and onion table sauce with lime.

chile-fresh citrus-bright cilantro-herbal

chile body; home substitute herbal lift savory depth crunch and aroma tartness blending liquid

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 1 piece ● Fresh Fresno chile, stemmed and seeded
- 15 g ● Fresh cilantro, washed
- 5 g ● Fresh garlic, peeled
- 2 tbsp ● Fresh white onion, finely chopped
- 1 tbsp ● Lime juice
- 3 tbsp ● Water

Make it

1. Wear gloves to trim and seed the chile; wash the herbs.
2. Blend chile, cilantro, garlic, lime and water until saucy.
3. Stir in finely chopped onion and refrigerate promptly.

WHERE IT SHINES

Cooked potatoes, beans, vegetables or empanadas.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per serving; chile heat varies.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Use genuine Ecuadorian ají peppers when available, starting with 0.5 pepper and adjusting; not all peppers have equal heat.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No major allergens intentionally added; check labels and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at or below 4°C/40°F; use within 4 days. Freeze portions for longer keeping. Citrus or vinegar does not make this shelf-stable.

Flavor reference: Ají criollo — Layla Pujol
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Italian-American pantry herb blend

A convenient oregano–basil jar inspired by Italian cooking; not a single national Italian formula.

herbal resinous sweet-green

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tsp	● Dried oregano
2 tsp	● Dried basil
1 tsp	● Dried thyme
1 tsp	● Dried marjoram
½ tsp	● Dried rosemary, finely crushed
1 tsp	● Dried parsley

Make it

1. Crush rosemary so no sharp needles remain.
2. Stir all dried herbs together.
3. Label the jar and date it.

WHERE IT SHINES

Tomato sauces, baked vegetables, pizza sauce or garlic bread.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Add 0.25 tsp crushed red-pepper flakes for a hotter batch.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No common major allergen intentionally added; check packaged ingredients.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per 2 cups sauce or 450 g vegetables.

KEEPING IT

Airtight jar in a cool, dark, dry place; best quality within 1–3 months. Keep water and wet utensils out.

Flavor reference: For the Love of Cooking — Homemade Italian Seasoning
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Ligurian-style basil pesto

Basil, nuts, cheese and olive oil form a fresh mortar-style condiment; these are original small-batch proportions.

basil-bright nutty savory

fragrant green base nut richness pungency salty savor sharp savor silky carrier

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

30 g	● Fresh basil leaves, washed and dried
15 g	● Pine nuts
3 g	● Fresh garlic, peeled
20 g	● Finely grated Parmigiano-Reggiano
10 g	● Finely grated pecorino
45 ml	● Extra-virgin olive oil

Make it

1. Pound garlic and pine nuts, or pulse briefly.
2. Add dry basil leaves and pound to a paste.
3. Stir in cheeses and oil without heating the basil.

WHERE IT SHINES

Pasta, cooked beans, potatoes or a thin layer on toast.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tbsp per serving; loosen with a little freshly cooked pasta water.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Replace pine nuts with 15 g walnuts; call it a walnut variation.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Milk; pine nuts. Walnut variation contains tree nuts.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a covered container at 4°C/40°F or colder; use within 4 days. Never store garlic-in-oil at room temperature. Lemon or vinegar here is for flavor, not validated preservation.

Flavor reference: Italia Squisita — Pesto demonstrated by Ligurian Michelin chefs
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Sicilian-style salmoriglio

Lemon, oregano, garlic and oil make a bright finishing sauce, not a shelf-stable infused oil.

lemony oregano-led garlicky

rich carrier acidity fresh green note resinous aroma pungency loosens texture

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

45 ml	● Extra-virgin olive oil
20 ml	● Fresh lemon juice
1 tbsp	● Fresh parsley, finely chopped
½ tsp	● Dried oregano
3 g	● Fresh garlic, minced
10 ml	● Drinking water

Make it

1. Whisk lemon juice, water and minced garlic.
2. Rub oregano between your fingers and add with parsley.
3. Whisk in oil and spoon over cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES

Grilled vegetables, cooked fish, roasted mushrooms or beans.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tbsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Add 0.125 tsp dried chili flakes for a warmer finish.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No common major allergen intentionally added; check packaged ingredients.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a covered container at 4°C/40°F or colder; use within 4 days. Never store garlic-in-oil at room temperature. Lemon or vinegar here is for flavor, not validated preservation.

Flavor reference: Forager Chef — Italian Salmoriglio Sauce
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Herbes de Provence

A thyme-and-rosemary-led interpretation; lavender is omitted because it is not required in every version.

woody piney floral-herbal

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tsp	● Dried thyme
2 tsp	● Dried rosemary, finely crushed
¾ tsp	● Dried marjoram
¾ tsp	● Dried oregano

Make it

1. Finely crush the rosemary.
2. Combine with the other dried herbs.
3. Transfer to a labeled airtight jar.

WHERE IT SHINES

Roasted vegetables, bean stews and tomato sauces.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per 450 g vegetables or 2 cups stew.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Replace marjoram with the same amount of dried summer savory.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No common major allergen intentionally added; check packaged ingredients.

KEEPING IT

Airtight jar in a cool, dark, dry place; best quality within 1–3 months. Keep water and wet utensils out.

Flavor reference: RecipeTin Eats — Herbes de Provence
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Fresh fines herbes

A chopped mixture of four delicate fresh herbs, added near serving rather than long-simmered.

delicate anise-like fresh-green

green base gentle onion note delicate anise aroma stronger anise accent

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 1 ½ **tblsp** ● Fresh parsley, finely chopped
- 1 ½ **tblsp** ● Fresh chives, finely chopped
- 1 **tblsp** ● Fresh chervil, finely chopped
- ½ **tblsp** ● Fresh tarragon, finely chopped

Make it

1. Wash herbs and dry thoroughly.
2. Chop with a sharp knife without bruising into a wet pulp.
3. Combine and add at the end of cooking.

WHERE IT SHINES

Omelettes, cooked peas, mushrooms or herb butter.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 **tblsp** per 2 servings.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

If chervil is unavailable replace it with parsley; label this a three-herb variation.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No common major allergen intentionally added; check packaged ingredients.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a covered container at 4°C/40°F or colder; use within 4 days. Never store garlic-in-oil at room temperature. Lemon or vinegar here is for flavor, not validated preservation.

Flavor reference: MasterClass — Fines Herbes Recipe and Guide
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Quatre épices

A pepper-led four-spice blend with ginger, nutmeg and clove; use sparingly because clove dominates quickly.

peppery warm sweet-aromatic

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tsp	● Ground white pepper
¾ tsp	● Ground ginger
½ tsp	● Ground nutmeg
¼ tsp	● Ground cloves

Make it

1. Measure the ground spices with level spoons.
2. Mix until the clove is evenly distributed.
3. Jar and label; use a small first dose.

WHERE IT SHINES

Roasted carrots, mushroom pâté or lentil dishes.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.25 tsp per 2 cups cooked food.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Replace white pepper with black pepper for a darker, fruitier variation.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No common major allergen intentionally added; check packaged ingredients.

KEEPING IT

Airtight jar in a cool, dark, dry place; best quality within 1–3 months. Keep water and wet utensils out.

Flavor reference: The Kitchn — French Spice Mix: Quatre Epices
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Spanish-inspired paprika and garlic blend

An original seasoning built around Spanish pimentón; not an established national blend.

smoky garlicky sweet-pepper

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tsp	● Smoked sweet Spanish paprika
2 tsp	● Sweet Spanish paprika
1 tsp	● Garlic powder
½ tsp	● Dried thyme
½ tsp	● Ground black pepper

Make it

1. Mix the two paprikas first.
2. Stir in garlic, thyme and pepper.
3. Store dry; when cooking, avoid scorching paprika.

WHERE IT SHINES

Roasted potatoes, mushrooms, chickpeas or tomato sauces.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per 450 g vegetables.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Replace 0.25 tsp sweet paprika with hot pimentón.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No common major allergen intentionally added; check packaged ingredients.

KEEPING IT

Airtight jar in a cool, dark, dry place; best quality within 1–3 months. Keep water and wet utensils out.

Flavor reference: The Evil Chef — BBQ Spice Rub with Spanish paprika
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Catalan-style almond picada

An almond, bread, parsley and garlic finishing paste that thickens a simmering dish; picada has many regional forms.

toasted nutty garlicky

nut richness thickening body green aroma pungency loosens paste

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

20 g	● Unsalted toasted almonds
15 g	● Toasted wheat bread, cooled
1 tbsp	● Fresh parsley, chopped
3 g	● Fresh garlic, peeled
30 ml	● Drinking water

Make it

1. Pound almonds and toasted bread into coarse crumbs.
2. Add garlic and parsley and pound again.
3. Stir in water, then stir the paste into a simmering stew for 3–5 minutes.

WHERE IT SHINES

Vegetable, bean or mushroom stews.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tbsp per 2 cups stew.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Replace almonds with 20 g toasted hazelnuts; identify the nut clearly.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Almonds (tree nuts); wheat/gluten. Hazelnut variation contains tree nuts.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a covered container at 4°C/40°F or colder; use within 4 days. Never store garlic-in-oil at room temperature. Lemon or vinegar here is for flavor, not validated preservation.

Flavor reference: Almond Board of California — Catalan Almond Picada
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Portuguese-style piri-piri sauce

A small fresh chili-garlic sauce; piri-piri belongs to intertwined Portuguese and African food histories.

fiery tangy garlicky

heat pungency rich carrier acidity citrus pepper body

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

10 g	● Fresh red bird's-eye chilies, stemmed
6 g	● Fresh garlic, peeled
30 ml	● Olive oil
15 ml	● White wine vinegar
10 ml	● Fresh lemon juice
1 tsp	● Sweet paprika

Make it

1. Wear food-safe gloves when trimming the chilies.
2. Blend all measured ingredients into a coarse sauce.
3. Use a clean spoon; refrigerate promptly rather than aging this batch.

WHERE IT SHINES

Grilled vegetables, cooked beans or a tiny drizzle on cooked food.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.25–0.5 tsp per serving; bird's-eye chili heat varies.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Use 5 g chilies plus 20 g fresh red bell pepper for a milder variation.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Possible sulfites in wine vinegar; check its label.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a covered container at 4°C/40°F or colder; use within 4 days. Never store garlic-in-oil at room temperature. Lemon or vinegar here is for flavor, not validated preservation.

Flavor reference: Portugal Wine & Food — Piri-Piri Sauce
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Greek-style oregano and lemon dressing

A ladolemono-inspired lemon and olive-oil dressing with a restrained oregano accent.

citrusy fruity oregano-led

fruity carrier bright acidity herbal signature gentle bite

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

45 ml	● Extra-virgin olive oil
25 ml	● Fresh lemon juice
½ tsp	● Dried Greek oregano
⅛ tsp	● Ground black pepper

Make it

1. Whisk lemon juice, oregano and pepper.
2. Slowly whisk in olive oil.
3. Whisk again immediately before spooning over cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES

Roasted vegetables, cooked potatoes or grain bowls.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tbsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Add 0.5 tsp finely grated fresh lemon zest for more aroma.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No common major allergen intentionally added; check packaged ingredients.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a covered container at 4°C/40°F or colder; use within 4 days. Never store garlic-in-oil at room temperature. Lemon or vinegar here is for flavor, not validated preservation.

Flavor reference: Souvlaki For The Soul — Ladolemono
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Turkish-inspired pul biber and sumac sprinkle

An original finishing sprinkle joining two common Turkish seasonings; it is not presented as a traditional named blend.

tangy fruity-chili herbal



Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tsp	● Ground sumac
2 tsp	● Pul biber, Turkish red-pepper flakes
½ tsp	● Dried mint
¼ tsp	● Ground cumin

Make it

1. Check whether the pul biber already contains salt.
2. Combine sumac, pul biber, mint and cumin.
3. Sprinkle near serving to keep sumac bright.

WHERE IT SHINES

Bean salads, sliced onions, roasted vegetables or yogurt dips.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.5 tsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Omit cumin for a sharper sumac-and-pepper profile.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No common major allergen intentionally added; inspect sumac and pepper labels.

KEEPING IT

Airtight jar in a cool, dark, dry place; best quality within 1–3 months. Keep water and wet utensils out.

Flavor reference: Özlem's Turkish Table — sumac onions and pul biber in Turkish cooking
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Khmeli suneli-inspired herb blend

A modest home version of a variable Georgian blend; source blue fenugreek and culinary Imeretian marigold rather than assuming substitutes are identical.

nutty-herbal coriander-bright earthy



Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 2 tsp ● Ground coriander seed
- 1 tsp ● Ground blue fenugreek (utskho suneli)
- 1 tsp ● Dried dill
- 1 tsp ● Dried basil
- 1 tsp ● Dried summer savory
- ½ tsp ● Ground food-grade Imeretian marigold

Make it

1. Use labeled culinary spices, not ornamental garden flowers.
2. Crush the dried leaves and stir in ground spices.
3. Jar and date; stir into moist cooking rather than scorching it.

WHERE IT SHINES

Bean stews, walnut sauces or roasted vegetables.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per 2 cups food.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Omit unavailable marigold and label the result simplified; ordinary fenugreek is not a like-for-like substitute.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Fenugreek is a legume; individual legume allergies may matter. Check spice labels.

KEEPING IT

Airtight jar in a cool, dark, dry place; best quality within 1–3 months. Keep water and wet utensils out.

Flavor reference: Georgian Eats — Georgian Spices & Herbs
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Georgian-style fresh adjika

A small fresh pepper–garlic interpretation inspired by ajika, with home refrigeration rules rather than traditional preservation assumptions.

hot garlicky coriander-rich

heat pepper body pungent base citrusy warmth nutty depth green aroma seasoning

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

30 g	● Fresh red chilies, stemmed
60 g	● Fresh red bell pepper, seeded
12 g	● Fresh garlic, peeled
1 tsp	● Ground coriander seed
½ tsp	● Ground blue fenugreek
1 tbsp	● Fresh cilantro, chopped
¼ tsp	● Fine salt

Make it

1. Wear food-safe gloves; remove chili membranes for less heat.
2. Pulse peppers and garlic into a coarse paste.
3. Pulse in the spices, cilantro and measured salt.
4. Refrigerate promptly; do not treat this fresh low-salt version as preserved.

WHERE IT SHINES

Stir into cooked beans, vegetable stews or yogurt at serving.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.5 tsp per serving; increase after tasting.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Replace 15 g chili with the same weight of bell pepper for less heat.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Fenugreek is a legume; check individual allergies and labels.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a covered container at 4°C/40°F or colder; use within 4 days. Never store garlic-in-oil at room temperature. Lemon or vinegar here is for flavor, not validated preservation.

Flavor reference: Georgia Travel — Ajika traditions and recipes
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Bulgarian-style sharena sol

Colorful salt featuring summer savory, paprika and cumin; this recipe deliberately keeps the salt visible and measured.

savory-herbal paprika-sweet earthy

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 2 tsp ● Dried summer savory (chubritsa)
- 2 tsp ● Sweet paprika
- ½ tsp ● Ground cumin
- 1 tsp ● Fine salt

Make it

1. Rub summer savory to break large leaves.
2. Stir in paprika, cumin and salt evenly.
3. Jar and label it as a salt-containing blend.

WHERE IT SHINES

Toast, eggs, roasted vegetables or beans.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.25 tsp per serving; taste before adding other salt.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Add 0.25 tsp garlic powder as a clearly modern variation.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No common major allergen intentionally added; check packaged ingredients.

KEEPING IT

Airtight jar in a cool, dark, dry place; best quality within 1–3 months. Keep water and wet utensils out.

Flavor reference: How To Make Dinner — Sharena Sol Recipe
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Balkan ćevapi-inspired savory seasoning

A garlic-and-pepper pantry approximation for vegetables or patties; it is not a recipe for traditional ćevapi itself.

garlicky peppery savory

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tsp	● Garlic powder
1 tsp	● Onion powder
1 tsp	● Ground black pepper
½ tsp	● Sweet paprika

Make it

1. Stir powdered garlic and onion together.
2. Add pepper and paprika and mix thoroughly.
3. Use in a moist recipe or with oil on vegetables.

WHERE IT SHINES

Mushroom patties, roasted mushrooms or cooked bean patties.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Omit paprika for a simpler garlic-and-black-pepper profile.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No common major allergen intentionally added; check packaged ingredients.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per 450 g food; season salt separately.

KEEPING IT

Airtight jar in a cool, dark, dry place; best quality within 1–3 months. Keep water and wet utensils out.

Flavor reference: Recipes From Europe — Cevapi Recipe
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Hungarian-inspired paprika and caraway

A gulyás-inspired flavor base, not a claim that every Hungarian dish uses the same seasoning.

paprika-sweet caraway-aromatic savory

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 4 tsp ● Hungarian sweet paprika
- ½ tsp ● Ground caraway seed
- ¾ tsp ● Garlic powder
- ¼ tsp ● Ground black pepper

Make it

1. Mix paprika with caraway, garlic and pepper.
2. Store in a labeled airtight jar.
3. When cooking, stir into moist food or briefly off heat; paprika burns easily.

WHERE IT SHINES

Vegetable stews, mushroom sauces or cabbage.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per 2 cups stew.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Use 0.25 tsp hot Hungarian paprika in place of 0.25 tsp sweet paprika.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No common major allergen intentionally added; check packaged ingredients.

KEEPING IT

Airtight jar in a cool, dark, dry place; best quality within 1–3 months. Keep water and wet utensils out.

Flavor reference: The Daring Gourmet — Traditional Hungarian Goulash
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Polish-inspired marjoram and garlic

An original dry approximation of the garlic–marjoram pairing used in biała kiełbasa, useful beyond sausage.

marjoram-fragrant garlicky peppery

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

3 tsp ● Dried marjoram
1 tsp ● Garlic powder
½ tsp ● Ground black pepper

Make it

1. Rub marjoram gently between dry fingers.
2. Mix with garlic powder and pepper.
3. Stir into cooking and allow a few minutes for dried herbs to hydrate.

WHERE IT SHINES

Bean soup, mushrooms or cabbage.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per 2 cups soup or 450 g vegetables.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Add 0.25 tsp ground caraway for a cabbage-focused variation.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No common major allergen intentionally added; check packaged ingredients.

KEEPING IT

Airtight jar in a cool, dark, dry place; best quality within 1–3 months. Keep water and wet utensils out.

Flavor reference: Polish Your Kitchen — Fresh Polish Sausage, Biała Kiełbasa
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

German-inspired mustard and caraway

A pantry profile inspired by mustard gravies and caraway-seasoned vegetables; these proportions are an original combination.

mustard-sharp caraway-warm savory



Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tsp	● Ground yellow mustard seed
1/2 tsp	● Ground caraway seed
1 tsp	● Onion powder
1/4 tsp	● Ground black pepper

Make it

1. Mix the four ground ingredients.
2. Store dry in a labeled jar.
3. For use, whisk into a moist sauce; taste once the mustard has hydrated.

WHERE IT SHINES

Warm cabbage, potato salad or mushroom gravy.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.5 tsp per 2 cups food.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Add 0.5 tsp dried marjoram to the batch for a softer herb profile.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Mustard.

KEEPING IT

Airtight jar in a cool, dark, dry place; best quality within 1–3 months. Keep water and wet utensils out.

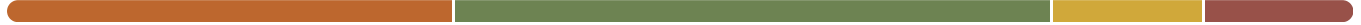
Flavor reference: The Daring Gourmet — Senfbraten mustard gravy

Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

British-inspired sage and onion seasoning

A dry flavor base inspired by sage-and-onion stuffing; breadcrumbs and animal ingredients are not part of this jar.

sage-resinous onion-sweet peppery



Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 1 ½ tsp ● Dried rubbed sage
- 2 tsp ● Onion powder
- ½ tsp ● Dried thyme
- ½ tsp ● Ground black pepper

Make it

1. Break up clumps of rubbed sage.
2. Mix with onion, thyme and pepper.
3. Stir into a moist mixture and taste after cooking.

WHERE IT SHINES

Bread stuffing, roasted squash or mushroom patties.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per 2 cups prepared mixture.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Replace 0.5 tsp sage with 0.5 tsp dried parsley for a gentler batch.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No common major allergen intentionally added; bread-based uses may contain wheat/gluten.

KEEPING IT

Airtight jar in a cool, dark, dry place; best quality within 1–3 months. Keep water and wet utensils out.

Flavor reference: Delia Smith via The Happy Foodie — Traditional Pork, Sage and Onion Stuffing
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Irish-inspired parsley and chive butter

An original herb butter inspired by Irish cooking's butter-and-fresh-herb accompaniments; not a national fixed blend.

buttery fresh-green gentle-onion

rich base green freshness gentle onion note citrus aroma

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 60 g ● Unsalted butter, softened
- 1 tbsp ● Fresh parsley, finely chopped
- 1 tbsp ● Fresh chives, finely chopped
- ½ tsp ● Fresh lemon zest, finely grated

Make it

1. Let butter soften only long enough to mash.
2. Fold in finely chopped herbs and lemon zest.
3. Refrigerate promptly in a covered container.
4. Spoon onto hot cooked food just before serving.

WHERE IT SHINES

Cooked potatoes, peas, mushrooms or toast.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Add 0.25 tsp fresh minced garlic for a garlic variation.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Milk.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a covered container at 4°C/40°F or colder; use within 4 days. Never store garlic-in-oil at room temperature. Lemon or vinegar here is for flavor, not validated preservation.

Flavor reference: Bord Bia — Harvesting and Cooking, parsley garlic butter
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Swedish-style mustard and dill sauce

An egg-free hovmästarsås-inspired dressing; Swedish mustard gives a different result from Dijon.

mustard-tangy dill-fresh lightly-sweet

pungent base acidity sweet balance emulsion body herbal signature

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tbsp	● Prepared Swedish mustard
10 ml	● White wine vinegar
1 tsp	● Granulated sugar
30 ml	● Neutral oil
1 ½ tbsp	● Fresh dill, finely chopped

Make it

1. Whisk mustard, vinegar and sugar until sugar begins dissolving.
2. Whisk in oil gradually to thicken.
3. Fold in the chopped dill and refrigerate.

WHERE IT SHINES

Cooked potatoes, roasted vegetables or cooked fish.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tbsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Use 1.5 tbsp Dijon in place of 2 tbsp Swedish mustard; expect a sharper sauce.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Mustard; possible sulfites in wine vinegar. Check labels.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a covered container at 4°C/40°F or colder; use within 4 days. Never store garlic-in-oil at room temperature. Lemon or vinegar here is for flavor, not validated preservation.

Flavor reference: Swedish Food — Gravadlax with mustard and dill sauce, sauce component
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Finnish-inspired dill and forest spice

An original dill-first mixture inspired by Finnish seasonal ingredients; juniper is an optional culinary accent, not an asserted traditional blend.

dill-green woody peppery



Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

3 tsp	● Dried dill
¼ tsp	● Ground white pepper
¼ tsp	● Dried thyme
⅛ tsp	● Food-grade culinary <i>Juniperus communis</i> berries, finely ground; optional

Make it

1. Use purchased food-grade culinary *Juniperus communis* only; omit juniper if identity is uncertain.
2. Finely grind the optional berries so no hard pieces remain.
3. Mix with dried dill, pepper and thyme.
4. Label the jar, including whether juniper was added.

WHERE IT SHINES

Roasted root vegetables, mushrooms or cooked potatoes.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.5 tsp per 450 g vegetables.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Omit juniper entirely for a simple dill-and-thyme blend.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No common major allergen intentionally added; check packaged ingredients.

KEEPING IT

Airtight jar in a cool, dark, dry place; best quality within 1–3 months. Keep water and wet utensils out.

Flavor reference: Visit Finland — Finnish food culture and seasonal ingredients
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Ukrainian-style fresh dill and garlic base

A small fresh finishing oil inspired by the garlic-and-dill coating on pampushky.

garlicky dill-bright savory

fresh herbal note pungency flavor carrier loosens texture

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- | | |
|--------|------------------------------|
| 2 tbsp | ● Fresh dill, finely chopped |
| 6 g | ● Fresh garlic, minced |
| 30 ml | ● Sunflower oil |
| 10 ml | ● Drinking water |

Make it

1. Wash and thoroughly dry the dill before chopping.
2. Stir minced garlic, dill, oil and water together.
3. Brush a small portion onto freshly cooked food.
4. Refrigerate leftovers immediately; this is not a shelf-stable garlic oil.

WHERE IT SHINES

Warm bread rolls, cooked potatoes or beans.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Replace 1 tbsp dill with 1 tbsp chopped fresh parsley.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No common major allergen intentionally added; bread uses may contain wheat/gluten.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a covered container at 4°C/40°F or colder; use within 4 days. Never store garlic-in-oil at room temperature. Lemon or vinegar here is for flavor, not validated preservation.

Flavor reference: Anna Voloshyna — Garlic and Dill Pampushky
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Romanian-style mujdei

A sharp garlic sauce diluted with water; the small batch uses original measures and has no preservation claim.

garlic-sharp pungent savory

signature pungency softens texture dilution seasoning

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- | | |
|---------|------------------------|
| 15 g | ● Fresh garlic, peeled |
| 10 ml | ● Neutral oil |
| 40 ml | ● Drinking water |
| 1⁄8 tsp | ● Fine salt |

Make it

1. Crush garlic with the measured salt to a fine paste.
2. Stir in oil a little at a time.
3. Add water gradually and stir until spoonable.
4. Use a clean spoon and refrigerate promptly.

WHERE IT SHINES

Roasted vegetables, cooked potatoes or cornmeal dishes.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.5 tsp per serving; garlic strength varies.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Add 1 tsp chopped fresh parsley; alternatively replace 15 ml water with plain yogurt and declare milk.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Base has no common major allergen intentionally added; yogurt variation contains milk.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a covered container at 4°C/40°F or colder; use within 4 days. Never store garlic-in-oil at room temperature. Lemon or vinegar here is for flavor, not validated preservation.

Flavor reference: e-Retete — Mujdei, Romanian Garlic Sauce
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Garam masala • warming finish

A small pantry interpretation; garam masala varies by cook and region.

warm floral peppery



Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tsp	● ground coriander
1 tsp	● ground cumin
½ tsp	● ground green cardamom
½ tsp	● ground Ceylon cinnamon
½ tsp	● ground black pepper
⅛ tsp	● ground cloves
⅛ tsp	● ground nutmeg

Make it

1. Measure into a clean dry bowl.
2. Stir thoroughly, crushing any lumps.
3. Transfer to a labeled airtight jar.

WHERE IT SHINES

Finish vegetable curries or lentils near the end of cooking.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.5 tsp per 500 g cooked food.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Add 0.25 tsp ground fennel for a sweeter version.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

KEEPING IT

Store airtight, cool and dark; use within 1–3 months for best aroma. Keep completely dry.

Flavor reference: Swasthi Shreekanth: Garam Masala
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Chaat masala • tart finishing dust

A deliberately tart finishing blend; kala namak contains salt and is not salt-free.

tangy sulfurous earthy



Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tsp	● amchur (dried mango powder)
1 tsp	● roasted ground cumin
½ tsp	● ground coriander
½ tsp	● kala namak (black salt)
¼ tsp	● ground black pepper
¼ tsp	● ground ginger
⅛ tsp	● cayenne

Make it

1. Measure into a clean dry bowl.
2. Stir thoroughly, crushing any lumps.
3. Transfer to a labeled airtight jar.

WHERE IT SHINES

Dust fruit, cucumber, roasted potatoes or chickpeas.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.25 tsp per 1 cup food; taste before adding more.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Amchur is defining here; lemon juice can brighten the dish separately but cannot be stored in this dry jar.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

KEEPING IT

Store airtight, cool and dark; use within 1–3 months for best aroma. Keep completely dry.

Flavor reference: Dassana Amit: Chaat Masala
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Tandoori-style red spice base

Spices evoke a tandoor-style marinade; an oven cannot reproduce a tandoor's full heat and smoke.

warm red-chili earthy



Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 2 tsp ● Kashmiri chili powder
- 2 tsp ● ground coriander
- 1 tsp ● ground cumin
- ½ tsp ● ground ginger
- ½ tsp ● garlic powder
- ¼ tsp ● ground turmeric
- ¼ tsp ● ground Ceylon cinnamon
- ⅛ tsp ● ground cloves

Make it

1. Measure into a clean dry bowl.
2. Stir thoroughly, crushing any lumps.
3. Transfer to a labeled airtight jar.

WHERE IT SHINES

For 500 g vegetables, mix 2 tsp blend with 3 tbsp plain yogurt and 1 tbsp lemon juice; roast until tender.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tsp per 500 g vegetables.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

For a brighter mild version replace half the chili with sweet paprika; yogurt adds milk allergen.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

KEEPING IT

Store airtight, cool and dark; use within 1–3 months for best aroma. Keep completely dry.

Flavor reference: Swasthi Shreekanth: Tandoori Chicken
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Panch phoron • whole five-seed tempering

Whole seeds, not a ground curry powder; this version uses mustard rather than radhuni.

anise-like nutty bittersweet



Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

1 tsp	● cumin seeds
1 tsp	● fennel seeds
1 tsp	● nigella seeds
1 tsp	● brown mustard seeds
½ tsp	● fenugreek seeds

Make it

1. Mix the whole seeds without grinding.
2. Store dry in a sealed jar.
3. For use, bloom a small portion in oil over medium heat until fragrant; guard against sputtering, then add vegetables.

WHERE IT SHINES

Temper potatoes, cabbage or lentils.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.5 tsp blend in 1 tbsp oil for 500 g vegetables.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Increase fenugreek to 1 tsp for an equal-part version, with a more bitter finish.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

mustard

KEEPING IT

Store airtight, cool and dark; use within 1–3 months for best aroma. Keep completely dry.

Flavor reference: Dassana Amit: Panch Phoron
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Sambar-style roasted spice powder

A small roasted-lentil blend, one interpretation among many regional sambar powders.

roasted coriander-rich mildly hot

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tbsp	● coriander seeds
1 tsp	● chana dal (dry split chickpeas)
1 tsp	● urad dal (dry split black gram)
1 tsp	● cumin seeds
¼ tsp	● fenugreek seeds
1 tsp	● dried mild chili flakes
½ tsp	● ground turmeric

Make it

1. Toast the two dals over low heat until golden and fragrant; transfer to a plate.
2. Toast whole seeds separately, then the chili briefly; cool everything completely.
3. Grind finely, stir in turmeric, and seal.

WHERE IT SHINES

Simmer into cooked lentils with vegetables and tamarind; this jar is seasoning, not complete sambar.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tsp per 3 cups lentil stew; simmer at least 10 minutes.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Add dry curry leaves only if fully crisp; omit for pantry simplicity.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

KEEPING IT

Store airtight, cool and dark; use within 1–3 months for best aroma. Keep completely dry.

Flavor reference: Swasthi Shreekanth: Sambar Powder
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Sri Lankan-style roasted curry powder

A toasted coriander-cumin backbone inspired by Sri Lankan roasted curry powders.

dark-roasted peppery warm

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tbsp	● coriander seeds
2 tsp	● cumin seeds
1 tsp	● fennel seeds
1 tsp	● black peppercorns
½ tsp	● cardamom seeds
¼ tsp	● whole cloves
½ tsp	● ground Ceylon cinnamon

Make it

1. Toast whole spices separately over low heat, stirring until fragrant; do not scorch.
2. Cool completely, then grind in a clean spice grinder.
3. Mix with any preground spices and seal in a labeled jar.

WHERE IT SHINES

Cook into pumpkin, mushroom or jackfruit curry with onion and a liquid base.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tsp per 500 g vegetables.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Add chili to the dish separately so roasting depth and chili heat stay independently adjustable.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

KEEPING IT

Store airtight, cool and dark; use within 1–3 months for best aroma. Keep completely dry.

Flavor reference: Dini Kodippili: Sri Lankan Roasted Curry Powder
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Momo-style filling masala

An original spice shortcut for vegetable filling, not a universal Nepali momo formula.

earthy warm peppery

Measured volumes before mixing • whole and ground forms as specified

Measure • 1× ingredient batch

2 tsp	● ground cumin
2 tsp	● ground coriander
1 tsp	● ground ginger
½ tsp	● ground turmeric
½ tsp	● ground black pepper
¼ tsp	● ground Ceylon cinnamon

Make it

1. Measure into a clean dry bowl.
2. Stir thoroughly, crushing any lumps.
3. Transfer to a labeled airtight jar.

WHERE IT SHINES

Season a cooked cabbage-and-mushroom dumpling filling with fresh garlic and scallions.

STARTING AMOUNT • ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per 500 g filling; cool filling before assembling dumplings.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Add 0.125 tsp ground timur for a Nepali citrus-numbing accent when available.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

KEEPING IT

Store airtight, cool and dark; use within 1–3 months for best aroma. Keep completely dry.

Flavor reference: Momo Ghar: Nepali Momo via Food Network
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Karahi-style coriander-pepper mix

A dry starting point; the dish's tomato, fresh ginger and garlic are equally important.

peppery citrusy warm

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tsp	● ground coriander
1 tsp	● ground cumin
1 tsp	● ground black pepper
1 tsp	● Kashmiri chili powder
¼ tsp	● ground turmeric
⅛ tsp	● ground green cardamom

Make it

1. Measure into a clean dry bowl.
2. Stir thoroughly, crushing any lumps.
3. Transfer to a labeled airtight jar.

WHERE IT SHINES

Bloom in oil, then simmer with chopped tomatoes, fresh ginger and mushrooms.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tsp per 500 g mushrooms and tomatoes.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Crush freshly toasted coriander seeds instead of powder for a textured finish.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

KEEPING IT

Store airtight, cool and dark; use within 1–3 months for best aroma. Keep completely dry.

Flavor reference: Izzah Cheema: Pakistani Chicken Karahi
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Char masala • Afghan-style rice warmth

A four-spice home interpretation for aromatic rice and vegetables.

warm floral earthy

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 2 tsp ● ground cumin
- 1 tsp ● ground green cardamom
- 1 tsp ● ground Ceylon cinnamon
- ¼ tsp ● ground cloves

Make it

1. Measure into a clean dry bowl.
2. Stir thoroughly, crushing any lumps.
3. Transfer to a labeled airtight jar.

WHERE IT SHINES

Stir a small amount into rice pilaf or carrot-and-raisin vegetables.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Reduce cloves to 0.125 tsp for a softer aroma.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.5 tsp per 1 cup uncooked rice, added during cooking.

KEEPING IT

Store airtight, cool and dark; use within 1–3 months for best aroma. Keep completely dry.

Flavor reference: Mirriam Seddiq: Afghan Char Masala
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Chinese five-spice • anise-led

Five-spice formulas vary; use food-grade culinary star anise.

anise sweet-warm citrus-numbing

Measured volumes before mixing • whole and ground forms as specified

Measure • 1× ingredient batch

1 tsp	● ground star anise
1 tsp	● ground fennel
¾ tsp	● ground Ceylon cinnamon
½ tsp	● ground Sichuan pepper (husks)
¼ tsp	● ground cloves

Make it

1. Measure into a clean dry bowl.
2. Stir thoroughly, crushing any lumps.
3. Transfer to a labeled airtight jar.

WHERE IT SHINES

Use sparingly in mushroom braises or roasted squash.

STARTING AMOUNT • ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.25 tsp per 500 g food.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Reduce star anise to 0.5 tsp if its licorice note dominates.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

KEEPING IT

Store airtight, cool and dark; use within 1–3 months for best aroma. Keep completely dry.

Flavor reference: The Woks of Life: How to Make Five Spice Powder
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Sichuan mala finishing dust

An original dry accent emphasizing ma (tingle) and la (chili heat); not a complete Sichuan sauce.

numbing hot citrusy

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tsp	● mild chili flakes
1 tsp	● ground Sichuan pepper (husks)
½ tsp	● ground cumin
½ tsp	● garlic powder
¼ tsp	● ground ginger

Make it

1. Measure into a clean dry bowl.
2. Stir thoroughly, crushing any lumps.
3. Transfer to a labeled airtight jar.

WHERE IT SHINES

Toss roasted cauliflower with oil and a small pinch, or finish noodles.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.25 tsp per 1 cup food.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Add more Sichuan pepper for tingle or cayenne for heat; they do different jobs.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

KEEPING IT

Store airtight, cool and dark; use within 1–3 months for best aroma. Keep completely dry.

Flavor reference: The Woks of Life: Mapo Tofu
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Cantonese-style ginger-scallion sauce

A gently cooked aromatic topping rather than a risky hot-oil pour.

fresh gingery savory

warm bite green allium carrier seasoning

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 2 tbsp ● finely minced fresh ginger
- 4 tbsp ● finely sliced scallions
- 2 tbsp ● neutral oil
- ¼ tsp ● fine salt

Make it

1. Wash and dry scallions; finely mince ginger.
2. Warm oil in a pan over medium-low heat; cook ginger for 1 minute.
3. Add scallions and salt; stir for 30 seconds, remove from heat and cool promptly.

WHERE IT SHINES

Spoon over warm tofu or steamed vegetables.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Add 0.25 tsp white pepper for a sharper version.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at 4°C/40°F or below; use within 4 days. Never store garlic mixtures in oil at room temperature.

Flavor reference: Bill Leung / The Woks of Life: Cantonese Poached Chicken and Ginger-Scallion Sauce
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Shichimi-style seven-spice

Seven measured ingredients; ginger stands in for less accessible hemp or shiso in this home version.

chili citrus nutty

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 2 tsp ● red chili flakes
- 1 tsp ● dried orange peel powder
- 1 tsp ● toasted white sesame seeds
- 1 tsp ● toasted black sesame seeds
- 1 tsp ● finely crumbled dry nori
- ¼ tsp ● ground sansho pepper
- ¼ tsp ● ground ginger

Make it

1. Measure into a clean dry bowl.
2. Stir thoroughly, crushing any lumps.
3. Transfer to a labeled airtight jar.

WHERE IT SHINES

Finish noodle soup, rice or roasted vegetables.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.25 tsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Sichuan pepper can approximate sansho's tingle but has a different aroma.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

sesame

KEEPING IT

Store airtight, cool and dark for up to 1 month for quality; refrigerate if the room is warm. Keep dry.

Flavor reference: Namiko Hirasawa Chen: Shichimi Togarashi
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Nori-sesame furikake-style sprinkle

A fish-free dry interpretation, unlike versions using bonito or wet seasonings.

nutty marine savory-sweet

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tbsp	● toasted white sesame seeds
1 tsp	● toasted black sesame seeds
2 tbsp	● finely crumbled dry nori
½ tsp	● sugar
¼ tsp	● fine salt

Make it

1. Cool any freshly toasted sesame completely.
2. Crush seeds lightly and combine with nori, sugar and salt.
3. Store in a dry sealed jar; do not add wet soy sauce to this dry formula.

WHERE IT SHINES

Sprinkle on rice, popcorn or warm tofu.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Add 0.25 tsp dried orange peel for citrus; this variation is original.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

sesame

KEEPING IT

Store airtight, cool and dark for up to 1 month for quality; refrigerate if the room is warm. Keep dry.

Flavor reference: Namiko Hirasawa Chen: Furikake
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Gochujang bowl sauce

Uses purchased fermented gochujang; this is a quick serving sauce, not a home fermentation recipe.

sweet-hot tangy sesame

fermented chili body acid thinning balance carrier & balance savory

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 2 tbsp ● gochujang
- 1 tbsp ● rice vinegar
- 1 tbsp ● water
- 1 tsp ● sugar
- 1 tsp ● toasted sesame oil
- ½ tsp ● minced garlic

Make it

1. Check the gochujang label for soy, wheat and other allergens.
2. Whisk all ingredients until smooth.
3. Let stand 10 minutes in the refrigerator; stir before serving.

WHERE IT SHINES

Dress a vegetable rice bowl or warm tofu.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Add water by 1 tsp increments for a drizzle; sweetness and salt vary by brand.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

soy,sesame,wheat may be present in gochujang

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at 4°C/40°F or below; use within 4 days. Never store garlic mixtures in oil at room temperature.

Flavor reference: Maangchi: Bibimbap
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Gochugaru-sesame finishing blend

An original sprinkle using Korean ingredients; not a named traditional Korean blend.

fruity-chili nutty garlicky

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- | | |
|-------|------------------------|
| 2 tsp | ● gochugaru |
| 2 tsp | ● toasted sesame seeds |
| ½ tsp | ● garlic powder |
| ¼ tsp | ● ground ginger |
| ¼ tsp | ● fine salt |

Make it

1. Measure into a clean dry bowl.
2. Stir thoroughly, crushing any lumps.
3. Transfer to a labeled airtight jar.

WHERE IT SHINES

Finish stir-fried mushrooms or cucumber with a little vinegar.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.5 tsp per 1 cup food.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Swap half the sesame for crumbled dry nori for an original marine variation.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

sesame

KEEPING IT

Store airtight, cool and dark for up to 1 month for quality; refrigerate if the room is warm. Keep dry.

Flavor reference: Maangchi: Spicy Braised Tofu
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Thai-style red curry paste

A plant-based home approximation: miso replaces shrimp paste and changes the aroma.

chili lemongrass citrusy

color and heat citrus allium savory piney bite citrus warm citrus earth

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

10 g	● dried mild red chilies, stems removed
2 tbsp	● finely minced tender lemongrass
3 tbsp	● chopped shallot
1 tbsp	● chopped garlic
1 tbsp	● chopped galangal
½ tsp	● finely grated makrut lime zest
½ tsp	● ground coriander
¼ tsp	● ground cumin
1 tsp	● white miso
2 tbsp	● water

Make it

1. Soak chilies in hot water for 15 minutes, then drain; wash hands and avoid eyes.
2. Blend drained chilies with all measured ingredients to a fine paste.
3. To use, cook paste in oil for 2–3 minutes, then add the curry's liquid and vegetables.

WHERE IT SHINES

Build a coconut vegetable curry.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tbsp paste per 1 cup coconut milk; simmer vegetables until tender.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Ginger substitutes for galangal only as an approximation; it tastes warmer and less piney.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

soy in miso; check label for barley or wheat

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at 4°C/40°F or below; use within 4 days. Never store garlic mixtures in oil at room temperature.

Flavor reference: Pailin Chongchitnant: Thai Red Curry Paste
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Toasted-rice larb accent

Toasted rice brings aroma and texture; lime, herbs and seasoning still belong in the finished salad.

toasty crunchy mild-chili

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 2 tbsp ● uncooked glutinous rice
- ½ tsp ● dried mild chili flakes

Make it

1. Toast rice in a dry pan, stirring constantly until deep golden and fragrant; do not burn.
2. Cool completely and grind to a fine-sand texture.
3. Mix in chili and seal dry.

WHERE IT SHINES

Stir into a cooked mushroom larb-style salad with lime, mint and scallion.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per 1 cup prepared salad.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Plain uncooked jasmine rice is an accessible approximation with a slightly different texture.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

KEEPING IT

Store airtight, cool and dark; make small batches and use within 1 month for best aroma.

Flavor reference: Pailin Chongchitnant: Toasted Rice Powder
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Vietnamese-style lemongrass marinade

A home vegetable marinade inspired by lemongrass cooking, with soy sauce as a stated fish-sauce replacement.

lemongrass garlicky sweet-savory

citrus allium savory salty savor carrier browning heat

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tbsp	● finely minced tender lemongrass
1 tbsp	● minced shallot
1 tsp	● minced garlic
1 tbsp	● soy sauce
1 tbsp	● neutral oil
1 tsp	● sugar
¼ tsp	● chili flakes

Make it

1. Trim tough lemongrass layers and mince only the tender base.
2. Stir all ingredients thoroughly.
3. Coat vegetables or tofu, refrigerate 20 minutes, then cook until hot and tender.

WHERE IT SHINES

Use on 500 g tofu or mushrooms before pan cooking.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tbsp per 500 g food.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Fish sauce gives a different traditional marine flavor; replacing soy adds fish allergen.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

soy,wheat in many soy sauces

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at 4°C/40°F or below; use within 4 days. Never store garlic mixtures in oil at room temperature.

Flavor reference: Huy Vu: Vietnamese Spicy Lemongrass Chicken
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Khmer-style yellow kroeung

A fragrant aromatic paste; this version omits fermented fish paste rather than calling another ingredient identical.

lemongrass earthy citrusy

citrus backbone piney bite earth savory sweet allium citrus aroma blending

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 4 tbsp finely minced tender lemongrass
- 1 tbsp chopped galangal
- 1 tbsp chopped fresh turmeric
- 1 tbsp chopped garlic
- 2 tbsp chopped shallot
- 1 tsp makrut lime leaves, finely sliced without ribs
- 1 tbsp water

Make it

1. Wash aromatics and remove tough lemongrass layers and lime-leaf ribs.
2. Pound or blend all ingredients very finely.
3. Cook 2 tbsp paste in 1 tbsp oil until fragrant before adding vegetables and liquid.

WHERE IT SHINES

Flavor a vegetable stir-fry or coconut curry.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tbsp per 500 g vegetables.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Use 0.5 tsp ground turmeric if fresh is unavailable; the flavor and texture will differ.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at 4°C/40°F or below; use within 4 days. Never store garlic mixtures in oil at room temperature.

Flavor reference: Grantourismo: Cambodian Kroeung
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Lao jeow-style roasted chili relish

An original plant-based jeow-style relish; omits ingredients found in some jeow bong versions, including buffalo skin.

roasted hot tangy

heat sweet allium savory acid approximate salty savor balance

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

15 g	● fresh red chilies
50 g	● shallots, peeled
10 g	● garlic, peeled
1 tbsp	● lime juice
1 tsp	● soy sauce
½ tsp	● sugar

Make it

1. Dry-roast chilies, shallots and garlic in a pan until softened and lightly charred; ventilate well.
2. Cool briefly and pound or blend with lime juice, soy sauce and sugar.
3. Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container.

WHERE IT SHINES

Serve as a tiny relish with sticky rice or steamed vegetables.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.25 tsp per bite; chili heat varies greatly.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Use mostly mild red peppers with one hot chili for less heat.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

soy,wheat in many soy sauces

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at 4°C/40°F or below; use within 4 days. Never store garlic mixtures in oil at room temperature.

Flavor reference: Pha Khao Lao: Jeow Bong
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Filipino adobo • liquid braising base

Adobo is a cooking method with many versions; this liquid base is not a dry spice blend.

sour garlicky peppery

acid salty savor braising liquid savory pepper aroma herbal balance

Ingredient roles • no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure • 1× ingredient batch

3 tbsp	● cane vinegar
2 tbsp	● soy sauce
6 tbsp	● water
1 tbsp	● crushed garlic
½ tsp	● whole black peppercorns
1 piece	● dried bay leaf
½ tsp	● sugar

Make it

1. Combine the measured base in a saucepan.
2. Bring to a simmer and cook 5 minutes.
3. Add 500 g mushrooms or firm tofu; simmer until heated through and the liquid reduces as desired, then remove bay leaf.

WHERE IT SHINES

Braise mushrooms or tofu and spoon a little sauce over rice.

STARTING AMOUNT • ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Use the batch for 500 g food; dilute with water if too salty.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

White distilled vinegar approximates cane vinegar; soy-free white adobo is a different tradition.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

soy,wheat in many soy sauces

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at 4°C/40°F or below; use within 4 days. Never store garlic mixtures in oil at room temperature.

Flavor reference: Vanjo Merano: Filipino Chicken Adobo
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Inasal-style citrus-lemongrass marinade

A vegetable adaptation of the sour, aromatic profile; not a restaurant's recipe.

citrusy tangy gingery

citrus acid herbal lift warmth savory carrier browning heat

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tbsp	● calamansi juice
2 tbsp	● cane vinegar
1 tbsp	● finely minced tender lemongrass
1 tsp	● minced ginger
1 tsp	● minced garlic
1 tbsp	● neutral oil
1 tsp	● sugar
¼ tsp	● ground black pepper

Make it

1. Prepare and finely mince the aromatics.
2. Whisk with juice, vinegar, oil, sugar and pepper.
3. Toss with 500 g vegetables, refrigerate 20 minutes, then roast or grill until tender.

WHERE IT SHINES

Season grilled mushrooms or vegetable skewers.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 3 tbsp per 500 g vegetables.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Lime juice approximates calamansi but is not the same fruit; brush annatto oil on during cooking if desired.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at 4°C/40°F or below; use within 4 days. Never store garlic mixtures in oil at room temperature.

Flavor reference: Vanjo Merano: Chicken Inasal
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Balado-style red chili bumbu

A cooked red-chili aromatic base; bumbu is a broad category, not one fixed recipe.

red-chili tomato savory

chili body allium savory acid and body cooking balance seasoning

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

50 g	● mild red chilies, seeded
50 g	● chopped shallots
10 g	● chopped garlic
100 g	● chopped tomato
1 tbsp	● neutral oil
½ tsp	● sugar
¼ tsp	● fine salt

Make it

1. Blend chilies, shallots, garlic and tomato to a rough paste.
2. Cook in oil over medium-low heat for 8–10 minutes, stirring until raw aroma fades.
3. Stir in sugar and salt; cool promptly if not using immediately.

WHERE IT SHINES

Coat cooked eggplant, tofu or potatoes.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tbsp per 1 cup cooked food.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

A small hot chili increases heat; use a sweet red pepper for a deliberately milder approximation.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at 4°C/40°F or below; use within 4 days. Never store garlic mixtures in oil at room temperature.

Flavor reference: Anita: Telur Balado, Daily Cooking Quest
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Malay-style rempah aromatic base

A home aromatic base; rempah formulas depend on the dish and cook.

lemongrass warm savory

sweet allium savory citrus warmth piney aroma heat citrus earth

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

60 g	● chopped shallots
10 g	● chopped garlic
2 tbsp	● finely minced tender lemongrass
1 tbsp	● chopped ginger
1 tbsp	● chopped galangal
1 tsp	● mild red chili flakes
1 tsp	● ground coriander
½ tsp	● ground turmeric
1 tbsp	● neutral oil
2 tbsp	● water

Make it

1. Blend all ingredients except oil to a smooth paste.
2. Cook in oil over medium-low heat for 8–10 minutes, stirring often.
3. Use as a base before adding vegetables and the recipe's liquid; cool leftovers promptly.

WHERE IT SHINES

Build a vegetable curry with coconut milk.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tbsp paste per 1 cup liquid.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

This version omits belacan; adding shrimp paste changes both flavor and shellfish allergens.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at 4°C/40°F or below; use within 4 days. Never store garlic mixtures in oil at room temperature.

Flavor reference: Food Literacy Center: Malaysian Spice Paste
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Singapore-style laksa aromatic paste

A plant-based approximation using miso instead of shrimp components; not a definitive laksa formula.

chili citrusy savory

allium savory citrus herbal lift heat earth citrus approximate shrimp-free savor

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

50 g	● chopped shallots
10 g	● chopped garlic
2 tbsp	● finely minced tender lemongrass
1 tbsp	● chopped galangal
2 tsp	● mild red chili flakes
½ tsp	● ground turmeric
1 tsp	● ground coriander
1 tsp	● white miso
1 tbsp	● neutral oil
2 tbsp	● water

Make it

1. Blend everything except oil finely.
2. Cook paste in oil over medium-low heat for 5 minutes.
3. For soup, add coconut milk and unsalted broth, then simmer with cooked noodles and vegetables.

WHERE IT SHINES

Make a home laksa-style noodle bowl.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tbsp paste per 1 cup coconut milk plus 1 cup broth.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

The source uses shrimp-based laksa ingredients; miso does not duplicate their flavor.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

soy in miso; check for wheat or barley

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at 4°C/40°F or below; use within 4 days. Never store garlic mixtures in oil at room temperature.

Flavor reference: The Woks of Life: Laksa
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Myanmar-style onion curry base

An onion-forward base inspired by Burmese curries; not a claim that every regional curry is alike.

allium-rich warm mild-chili

body savory warmth color heat earth cooking blending

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

150 g	● chopped onion
15 g	● chopped garlic
15 g	● chopped ginger
1 tsp	● sweet paprika
⅛ tsp	● cayenne
½ tsp	● ground turmeric
2 tbsp	● neutral oil
2 tbsp	● water

Make it

1. Blend onion, garlic and ginger with water.
2. Cook in oil over medium-low heat for 12–15 minutes, stirring until softened and aromatic.
3. Add spices; stir 1 minute before adding vegetables and enough water to simmer.

WHERE IT SHINES

Build a vegetable or chickpea curry.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 3 tbsp cooked base per 500 g vegetables.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

The source discusses fish sauce in some curries; season the finished dish separately and check labels.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at 4°C/40°F or below; use within 4 days. Never store garlic mixtures in oil at room temperature.

Flavor reference: Burmawala Kitchen: Burmese Curry
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Taiwanese-style salt-pepper dust

A small finishing seasoning; salt is an ingredient and serving size matters.

white-pepper warm savory

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tsp	● ground white pepper
1 tsp	● fine salt
¼ tsp	● ground Ceylon cinnamon
⅛ tsp	● ground star anise
⅛ tsp	● ground fennel
1/16 tsp	● ground cloves
½ tsp	● garlic powder

Make it

1. Measure into a clean dry bowl.
2. Stir thoroughly, crushing any lumps.
3. Transfer to a labeled airtight jar.

WHERE IT SHINES

Finish crisp cooked tofu or mushrooms; fried basil can add a separate fresh accent.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.25 tsp per 1 cup cooked food.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Reduce salt to 0.5 tsp for a pepper-led version; do not label it sodium-free.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

KEEPING IT

Store airtight, cool and dark; use within 1–3 months for best aroma. Keep completely dry.

Flavor reference: Nyonya Cooking: Taiwanese Salt & Pepper Chicken
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Hawai'i shoyu poke-style dressing

A home dressing for cooked tofu; does not represent all Hawaiian poke traditions or require raw fish.

savory sesame fresh-allium

salty savor dilution carrier & balance fresh allium crunch nutty heat

Ingredient roles • no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure • 1× ingredient batch

- 1 tbsp soy sauce
- 1 tbsp water
- 1 tsp toasted sesame oil
- 2 tbsp finely sliced scallion
- 1 tbsp minced sweet onion
- 1 tsp toasted sesame seeds
- 1/8 tsp chili flakes

Make it

1. Stir soy sauce, water and sesame oil together.
2. Fold in the fresh alliums, sesame and chili.
3. Toss with chilled cooked tofu just before serving; keep refrigerated.

WHERE IT SHINES

Dress 250 g cooked tofu or cooked mushrooms.

STARTING AMOUNT • ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tbsp dressing per 250 g food.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Traditional limu and inamona have distinct identities; this dressing does not claim to replace them.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

soy,sesame,wheat in many soy sauces

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at 4°C/40°F or below; use within 4 days. Never store garlic mixtures in oil at room temperature.

Flavor reference: Kathy YL Chan: Hawaii-Style Poke
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Lemon-myrtle herb blend

An original culinary herb mix using purchased food-grade lemon myrtle; no foraging or essential oils.

lemony herbal peppery

Measured volumes before mixing • whole and ground forms as specified

Measure • 1× ingredient batch

- | | |
|-------|---------------------------------|
| ½ tsp | ● food-grade dried lemon myrtle |
| 1 tsp | ● dried thyme |
| 2 tsp | ● dried parsley |
| ½ tsp | ● ground black pepper |
| ½ tsp | ● garlic powder |

Make it

1. Measure into a clean dry bowl.
2. Stir thoroughly, crushing any lumps.
3. Transfer to a labeled airtight jar.

WHERE IT SHINES

Season roasted vegetables with oil or stir into a dressing immediately before use.

STARTING AMOUNT • ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.5 tsp blend per 500 g vegetables.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Native thyme can replace regular thyme only when sold as a culinary food ingredient; this is not an Indigenous community recipe.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

KEEPING IT

Store airtight, cool and dark; use within 1–3 months for best aroma. Keep completely dry.

Flavor reference: Daintree Spice Co.: Native Lemon Myrtle Blend Reference
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Pacific-inspired coconut-lime marinade

A cooked-food marinade inspired by coconut-citrus combinations; Pacific cuisines are distinct, not one formula.

creamy citrusy fresh

creamy body acid allium warmth heat seasoning

Ingredient roles • no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure • 1× ingredient batch

½ cup	● canned coconut milk
2 tbsp	● lime juice
2 tbsp	● finely sliced scallion
1 tsp	● grated ginger
¼ tsp	● finely diced red chili
⅛ tsp	● fine salt

Make it

1. Whisk coconut milk and lime juice; a little separation is normal.
2. Stir in scallion, ginger, chili and salt.
3. Use as a short refrigerated vegetable marinade or sauce for fully cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES

Coat 500 g vegetables before roasting, or spoon over cooked food.

STARTING AMOUNT • ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tbsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Citrus does not make raw fish reliably safe; this guide uses vegetables and cooked food only.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at 4°C/40°F or below; use within 4 days. Never store garlic mixtures in oil at room temperature.

Flavor reference: Tourism Fiji: Kokoda flavor reference
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Bhutan-inspired tomato-chili ezay

An ezay-inspired table relish; household versions differ and this one deliberately omits cheese.

hot fresh citrus-tingle

juicy body heat allium savory tingle approximation seasoning

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- | | |
|--------|---------------------------|
| 100 g | ● chopped ripe tomato |
| 10 g | ● fresh red chili, seeded |
| 1 tbsp | ● chopped scallion |
| ½ tsp | ● minced garlic |
| ⅛ tsp | ● ground Sichuan pepper |
| ⅛ tsp | ● fine salt |

Make it

1. Wash produce; finely chop tomato, chili and scallion.
2. Pound chili and garlic, then fold in remaining ingredients.
3. Serve in small amounts and refrigerate promptly.

WHERE IT SHINES

Serve alongside cooked vegetables or rice.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.5 tsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Sichuan pepper approximates local pepper character; adding cheese introduces milk allergen.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at 4°C/40°F or below; use within 4 days. Never store garlic mixtures in oil at room temperature.

Flavor reference: Druk Gyalpo's Institute / Royal Academy — Seven Gifts Recipes 2024, current official edition
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Yoruba-style efo riro pepper-and-green foundation

A measured, fish-free adaptation of the pepper-and-palm-oil base used for efo riro; it omits the crayfish and meats in the reference, changing its savor.

pepper-rich leafy fermented-savory

sweet pepper body sweet allium chili heat rich cooking carrier fermented savory aroma leafy body cooking moisture

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

150 g	● Fresh red bell pepper, stemmed and seeded
60 g	● Fresh onion, peeled and finely chopped
2 g	● Fresh Scotch bonnet chili, stemmed; wear gloves
1 tbsp	● Food-grade red palm oil
1 tsp	● Commercial ready-to-cook iru / fermented African locust beans
100 g	● Fresh spinach, washed and chopped
30 ml	● Drinking water

Make it

1. Coarsely pulse bell pepper, half the onion and chili; reserve the remaining onion.
2. Warm palm oil gently; soften reserved onion for 4 minutes. Add blended peppers and cook 12–15 minutes, stirring to prevent scorching.
3. Add iru and the measured water; simmer 3 minutes. Stir in spinach and cook 3–5 minutes until wilted and hot.
4. Serve a clean portion or cool promptly in a shallow container and refrigerate.

WHERE IT SHINES

Use as a cooked greens-and-pepper topping or fold into cooked vegetables.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tbsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Omit unavailable iru and label the result simplified; it loses fermented aroma. This Yoruba reference is distinct from a seed-thickened ogbono base, and neither defines all Nigerian cooking.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Check commercial iru for ingredients and cross-contact; locust bean is a legume. This version omits the reference's shellfish and fish.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at 4°C/40°F or colder; use within 4 days or an earlier ingredient-label limit. Cool cooked leftovers in shallow containers within 2 hours. Freeze spare portions. Oil, lemon and vinegar do not make these mixtures shelf-stable.

Flavor reference: Chef Lola's Kitchen — Efo Riro, including Yoruba naming and iru
Source-informed home adaptation; not kitchen-tested

Nigerian ogbono-style seed foundation

A small mushroom adaptation of an ogbono seed-thickened sauce. It omits the reference's fish, meat and fermented seasoning; ogbono is not exclusive to one community.

seed-rich earthy pepper-warm

slippery seed thickener rich carrier allium savor vegetable savor sauce liquid pepper body gentle heat leafy finish

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

20 g	● Purchased food-grade ground ogbono (African mango seed)
½ tbsp	● Food-grade red palm oil
20 g	● Fresh onion, peeled and finely chopped
60 g	● Fresh cultivated mushrooms, cleaned and finely chopped
200 ml	● Drinking water
20 g	● Fresh red bell pepper, seeded and finely chopped
⅛ tsp	● Pure ground mild red chili
30 g	● Fresh spinach, washed and chopped

Make it

1. Simmer onion and mushrooms in 150 ml of the measured water for 5 minutes.
2. In a separate saucepan gently melt palm oil, remove from heat and stir in ogbono; do not fry the seeds.
3. Gradually stir in mushroom liquid, mushrooms, onion and remaining 50 ml water. Add bell pepper and chili; simmer gently 20 minutes, stirring often and adding a little water if needed.
4. Stir in spinach and simmer 3 minutes; cool leftovers promptly.

WHERE IT SHINES

Use as a seed-thickened cooked vegetable sauce; the elastic texture is part of the profile.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tbsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

This is a mushroom-based home adaptation, not a full traditional ogbono soup. The Igbo name does not establish exclusive origin or uniform household practice.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No common major allergen intentionally added; ogbono is a seed ingredient and individual allergies remain possible. Check its package.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at 4°C/40°F or colder; use within 4 days or an earlier ingredient-label limit. Cool cooked leftovers in shallow containers within 2 hours. Freeze spare portions. Oil, lemon and vinegar do not make these mixtures shelf-stable.

Flavor reference: All Nigerian Recipes — Ogbono Soup, seed-oil technique and simmering
Source-informed home adaptation; not kitchen-tested

Mozambique-inspired lemon piri-piri base

A cooked onion, lemon and chili sauce inspired by a firsthand Mozambique cooking account; this original batch is distinct from the atlas's Portuguese piri-piri version.

lemon-sharp chili-hot onion-savory

heat savory body pungency sharp acidity cooking carrier pepper warmth cooking moisture

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

8 g	● Fresh red bird's-eye / piri-piri chilies, stemmed
40 g	● Fresh onion, peeled and finely chopped
6 g	● Fresh garlic, peeled and minced
40 ml	● Fresh lemon juice
1 tsp	● Neutral oil
½ tsp	● Sweet paprika
20 ml	● Drinking water

Make it

1. Wear food-safe gloves; chop chilies and avoid touching your eyes.
2. Soften onion in oil over medium-low heat for 5 minutes; add garlic for 30 seconds.
3. Add chilies, lemon juice, paprika and water. Simmer gently 8–10 minutes, stirring; cool briefly and blend coarsely.
4. Use a clean serving spoon and refrigerate promptly.

WHERE IT SHINES

Serve a small amount beside cooked vegetables or use as a hot finishing base.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.125–0.25 tsp per serving; chili strength varies.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

For a milder batch replace 4 g chili with 20 g fresh red bell pepper. This follows one Mozambique account, not a universal Angolan or Mozambican formula.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No common major allergen intentionally added; check ingredient labels.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at 4°C/40°F or colder; use within 4 days or an earlier ingredient-label limit. Cool cooked leftovers in shallow containers within 2 hours. Freeze spare portions. Oil, lemon and vinegar do not make these mixtures shelf-stable.

Flavor reference: Maryland to Mozambique — Cooking with Lesh: Mozambican Piri Piri Sauce
Source-informed home adaptation; not kitchen-tested

Congolese-inspired spinach and peanut foundation

A fish-free spinach-and-peanut adaptation informed by a Congolese diaspora recipe. Traditional fumbwa uses Gnetum leaves; this recipe uses ordinary spinach and no cassava leaves.

peanut-rich leafy tomato-savory

leafy base rich binding body juicy acidity sweet allium savory aroma rich carrier simmering liquid gentle warmth

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

150 g	● Fresh spinach, washed and finely chopped
1 tbsp	● Unsweetened smooth peanut butter
60 g	● Fresh ripe tomato, chopped
30 g	● Fresh onion, peeled and finely chopped
3 g	● Fresh garlic, peeled and minced
1 tsp	● Food-grade red palm oil
100 ml	● Drinking water
⅛ tsp	● Pure mild red chili powder

Make it

1. Simmer spinach, onion, tomato, garlic and 75 ml of the measured water for 8 minutes, stirring.
2. Whisk peanut butter with the remaining 25 ml water; add to the pan with palm oil and chili.
3. Simmer gently 10 minutes, stirring until smooth; add a little water if the sauce sticks.
4. Serve over cooked food or cool promptly in a shallow container and refrigerate.

WHERE IT SHINES

Use as a cooked leafy peanut sauce with rice, cooked vegetables or a suitable starch.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tbsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

The reference contains smoked fish; omitting it changes the savor. Spinach is not identical to Gnetum, and this is not pondu or a cassava-leaf preparation. Do not substitute raw cassava leaves into these instructions.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Peanuts. Check peanut butter ingredients and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at 4°C/40°F or colder; use within 4 days or an earlier ingredient-label limit. Cool cooked leftovers in shallow containers within 2 hours. Freeze spare portions. Oil, lemon and vinegar do not make these mixtures shelf-stable.

Flavor reference: NKOSI — Congolese Fumbwa with spinach, peanut paste and palm oil
Source-informed home adaptation; not kitchen-tested

Maple–juniper–sumac vegetable dust

An original home ratio inspired by Oglala Lakota chef Sean Sherman's published maple–juniper cooking. This is not claimed as a traditional Lakota blend or a universal Indigenous flavor.

maple-sweet piney tart

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 2 tsp ● Maple sugar
- 1 tsp ● Culinary ground sumac
- ¼ tsp ● Food-grade dried juniper berries, finely ground

Make it

1. Finely grind purchased culinary juniper berries; measure the powder after grinding.
2. Blend with maple sugar and sumac until even.
3. Use lightly on oiled vegetables; maple sugar can burn over high direct heat.

WHERE IT SHINES

Roasted squash or carrots.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.5 tsp per cup vegetables, plus 1 tsp sunflower oil; roast at 190°C/375°F until tender.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

For a more tart personal version, add 0.5 tsp sumac to the batch.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Check purchased spices for allergens and cross-contact.
Use culinary products; do not gather unidentified juniper or sumac.

KEEPING IT

Airtight in a cool, dark, dry cupboard; best quality within 1–3 months.

Flavor reference: Sean Sherman with Beth Dooley, Maple-Juniper Roast Pheasant — published by permission in The Splendid Table; flavor inspiration Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Guatemalan-inspired toasted-seed pepián recado

An original vegetable cooking base informed by Guatemalan family pepián: toasted squash seeds, sesame, chiles and charred vegetables. This is a recado adaptation, not the complete stew.

toasty chile-earthy tomato-rich

toasty body nutty aroma sauce body tartness aromatic sweetness savory depth home substitute for guaque home substitute for pasa

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 tbsp	● Hulled pumpkin seeds / pepitas
1 tbsp	● Sesame seeds
250 g	● Fresh tomatoes, chopped
75 g	● Fresh tomatillos, husks removed and washed
60 g	● Fresh onion, peeled and quartered
6 g	● Fresh garlic, peeled
6 g	● Dried pasilla chile, stemmed and seeded
6 g	● Dried ancho chile, stemmed and seeded
⅛ tsp	● Ground cinnamon
1 cup	● Water

Make it

1. Toast seeds in a dry skillet over medium heat for 2–4 minutes, stirring; remove when fragrant, before darkening. Briefly warm chiles for 15 seconds per side.
2. Roast tomatoes, tomatillos, onion and garlic at 220°C/425°F for 20 minutes until softened and blistered.
3. Cover chiles with the measured 1 cup hot water for 15 minutes; blend chiles and all that liquid with seeds, vegetables and cinnamon.
4. Simmer the blended paste gently for 10 minutes, stirring; cool in a shallow container and refrigerate within 2 hours.

WHERE IT SHINES

A cooking sauce for squash, green beans or potatoes.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 3 tbsp recado per cup cooked vegetables; simmer together 5 minutes.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Use genuine Guatemalan guaque and pasa chiles in place of the listed substitutes, beginning with the same weight and adjusting heat.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Sesame; pumpkin seed sensitivity possible. Check labels and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at or below 4°C/40°F; use within 4 days. Vinegar does not make this shelf-stable.

Venezuelan-style avocado guasacaca

An original small-batch take on the avocado, green pepper, cilantro and vinegar sauce described by Venezuelan creator Oriana Romero.

creamy green-herbal vinegar-bright

creamy body green pepper aroma allium bite savory depth herbal lift tartness smoothness blending liquid

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

150 g	● Ripe avocado flesh, skin and pit removed
40 g	● Fresh green bell pepper, stemmed and seeded
25 g	● Fresh white onion, peeled
3 g	● Fresh garlic, peeled
10 g	● Fresh cilantro, washed
1 tbsp	● White vinegar
1 tbsp	● Neutral oil
2 tbsp	● Water
1⁄8 tsp	● Ground black pepper

Make it

1. Wash pepper and herbs; peel onion and garlic and roughly chop.
2. Blend all measured ingredients until smooth; scrape the bowl and blend once more.
3. Chill 15 minutes, then stir and serve; refrigerate the remaining sauce promptly.

WHERE IT SHINES

Arepas, roasted vegetables or a dip for plantain chips.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tbsp per arepa or cup cooked vegetables.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Replace 1 tbsp vinegar with 1 tbsp lime juice for a citrus version.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No major allergens intentionally added; check all labels and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at or below 4°C/40°F; use within 4 days. Vinegar does not make this shelf-stable. Best color on the day made; avocado may brown.

Flavor reference: Venezuelan Guasacaca — Oriana Romero, Mommy's Home Cooking; flavor reference
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Barbados-inspired marjoram green seasoning

An original herb-heavy home ratio inspired by Slow Food Barbados. This reduced batch uses conservative refrigerated storage instead of adopting the source's extended keeping instructions.

marjoram-herbal garlicky chile-bright

allium base green allium green herb sweet herb backbone woody herb savory depth chile heat tartness and blending

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

80 g	● Fresh white onion, peeled and chopped
40 g	● Fresh scallions, trimmed and chopped
¼ cup	● Fresh parsley, washed and chopped
1 tbsp	● Fresh marjoram leaves
2 tsp	● Fresh thyme leaves
8 g	● Fresh garlic, peeled
2 g	● Fresh Scotch bonnet chile, stem and seeds removed
2 tbsp	● White vinegar
1/16 tsp	● Ground cloves
¼ tsp	● Ground black pepper

Make it

1. Wash herbs and produce. Wear gloves to prepare the chile; 2 g is a small portion, and heat varies.
2. Pulse onion, scallions, garlic and chile in a food processor.
3. Add herbs, vinegar, clove and pepper; blend to a thick paste and refrigerate promptly.

WHERE IT SHINES

Cooked beans, roasted squash or a vegetable braise.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per cup cooked beans; sauté the seasoning in 1 tsp oil for 2 minutes before adding beans.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

For a gentle batch replace 2 g Scotch bonnet with 15 g fresh sweet bell pepper.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No major allergens intentionally added; check labels and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at or below 4°C/40°F; use within 4 days. Vinegar does not make this shelf-stable.

Flavor reference: Bajan Fish Seasoning — Slow Food Barbados; herb and aromatic reference
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Uzbek zirvak-inspired carrot-cumin base

An original vegetable foundation inspired by plov's onion, carrot and cumin; a real zirvak commonly includes meat, and rice cooking is a separate technique.

sweet-carrot cumin browned-onion

savory sweetness sweet body earthy aroma cooking carrier softening seasoning

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

100 g	● thinly sliced onion
150 g	● julienned carrot
1 tsp	● cumin seeds
1 tbsp	● neutral oil
4 tbsp	● water
⅛ tsp	● fine salt

Make it

1. Warm oil in a pan over medium heat; cook onion for 5–7 minutes until golden, stirring.
2. Add carrots and cumin; cook for 4 minutes without scorching.
3. Add water and salt, cover and simmer 8–10 minutes until carrots are tender; mash lightly for a coarse base.

WHERE IT SHINES

Fold into already cooked rice or serve with cooked mushrooms; this is not a complete plov recipe.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 3 tbsp base per 1 cup cooked rice.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

For more browning, uncover and cook 1–2 minutes after softening; do not add a large curry-style spice register.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at 4°C/40°F or below; use within 4 days. Cool cooked mixtures in shallow containers; do not leave at room temperature for more than 2 hours.

Flavor reference: Svetlana Davydov and Elena / Jewish Food Society: Plov
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Tajik qurutob-inspired yogurt-onion sauce

A refrigerated yogurt approximation inspired by qurutob. It does not reproduce salted dried qurut, fatir bread or the whole traditional dish.

tangy onion-sweet herbal

tart creamy body thinning sweet allium cooking herbal finish seasoning

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 150 g plain unsweetened yogurt
- 3 tbsp water
- 75 g thinly sliced onion
- 1 tsp neutral oil
- 1 tsp fresh chopped dill
- 1⁄8 tsp fine salt

Make it

1. Cook onion in oil over medium-low heat for 8–10 minutes until softened and golden.
2. Whisk yogurt, water and salt in a bowl; do not boil this yogurt shortcut.
3. Cool onions until warm, fold into the sauce and add dill; refrigerate promptly if not serving now.

WHERE IT SHINES

Spoon over torn flatbread and cooked vegetables. Bread adds wheat unless a suitable alternative is used.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 3 tbsp sauce per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Use purchased qurut prepared according to its package in a separate traditional version; its salt content and dilution differ.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

milk

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at 4°C/40°F or below; use within 4 days. Cool cooked mixtures in shallow containers; do not leave at room temperature for more than 2 hours.

Flavor reference: Florian / Food Perestroika: Qurutob, observed in Dushanbe
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Kazakh tuzdyk-style onion broth

A vegetable-broth adaptation of an onion-and-broth accompaniment. Traditional meat broth contributes a flavor this version does not duplicate.

brothy peppery onion

allium liquid body richness pungency seasoning

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

100 g	● thinly sliced onion
200 ml	● unsalted vegetable broth
1 tsp	● unsalted butter
¼ tsp	● ground black pepper
⅛ tsp	● fine salt

Make it

1. Bring broth, butter, pepper and salt to a gentle boil in a saucepan.
2. Add sliced onion and simmer 5 minutes; retain some onion texture.
3. Serve hot; cool leftovers promptly in a shallow covered container.

WHERE IT SHINES

Spoon over cooked wide noodles and vegetables; this sauce alone is not beshbarmak.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 3 tbsp broth sauce per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Neutral oil can replace butter for a dairy-free original adaptation; commercial broth may add allergens or salt.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

milk; check broth label for celery, soy or wheat

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at 4°C/40°F or below; use within 4 days. Cool cooked mixtures in shallow containers; do not leave at room temperature for more than 2 hours.

Flavor reference: Chef Ravil Urushanov / Borjomi Gastro Guide: Kazakh-style Beshbarmak and Tuzdyk
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Mongolian buuz-inspired onion-garlic foundation

An original cooked allium base inspired by buuz filling. Buuz traditionally rely on meat, juiciness and steaming; this is not a Mongolian dry spice blend.

allium peppery savory

juicy allium savory aroma cooking carrier moisture pungency seasoning

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

100 g	● very finely chopped onion
1 piece	● garlic clove, peeled and minced
1 tsp	● neutral oil
2 tbsp	● water
¼ tsp	● ground black pepper
⅛ tsp	● fine salt

Make it

1. Warm oil over medium-low heat; cook onion for 4 minutes without browning deeply.
2. Add garlic, water, pepper and salt; cover and cook 3–4 minutes until softened.
3. Mash to a coarse paste and cool before mixing into a dumpling filling.

WHERE IT SHINES

Mix with cooked chopped mushrooms for a vegetable dumpling filling; steam assembled dumplings according to a complete dough recipe.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tbsp base per 250 g cooked mushroom filling.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

A little extra water adds juiciness but can make seams leak; add only 1 tsp at a time to the finished filling.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at 4°C/40°F or below; use within 4 days. Cool cooked mixtures in shallow containers; do not leave at room temperature for more than 2 hours.

Flavor reference: All Mongolian Recipes: Buuz, Steamed Filled Pockets
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Tibetan momo-inspired ginger-scallion base

An original aromatic shortcut inspired by a Tibetan family's vegetable momo formula. Fresh alliums and ginger, rather than an elaborate dry masala, carry this version.

ginger green-allium savory

allium body green aroma warmth savory salty savor cooking moisture

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

50 g	● finely chopped onion
2 tbsp	● finely sliced scallion
1 tsp	● fresh ginger, minced
1 piece	● garlic clove, peeled and minced
1 tsp	● soy sauce
1 tsp	● neutral oil
1 tbsp	● water

Make it

1. Warm oil over medium-low heat and cook onion for 3 minutes.
2. Add ginger, garlic, scallion, soy sauce and water; cook 2 minutes, stirring.
3. Cool, then mash or chop finely before mixing into cooked vegetable filling.

WHERE IT SHINES

Season cooked mushroom-and-tofu filling. Dumpling dough, assembly and steaming require a separate complete recipe.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tbsp base per 250 g filling.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Use labeled gluten-free tamari to avoid wheat where appropriate; it still contains soy and salt.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

soy,wheat in many soy sauces

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at 4°C/40°F or below; use within 4 days. Cool cooked mixtures in shallow containers; do not leave at room temperature for more than 2 hours.

Flavor reference: Lobsang Wangdu / YoWangdu: Tibetan Meat and Vegetable Momos
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Samoan palusami-inspired coconut-onion sauce

A sauce adaptation of coconut cream and onion used in palusami. Baking inside properly prepared taro leaves is part of the original dish; this sauce does not replace that technique.

coconut-rich onion-sweet mellow

rich body thinning savory sweetness seasoning

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

½ cup	● unsweetened canned coconut cream
2 tbsp	● water
50 g	● finely chopped onion
⅛ tsp	● fine salt

Make it

1. Combine coconut cream, water, onion and salt in a small saucepan.
2. Bring to a gentle simmer, then cook over low heat for 8–10 minutes, stirring, until onion softens.
3. Serve hot over fully cooked vegetables or cool promptly and refrigerate.

WHERE IT SHINES

Spoon over cooked spinach or roast vegetables as an accessible home adaptation.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tbsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Spinach is a practical alternative to taro leaves, not the same ingredient or traditional texture; never treat raw taro leaves as salad greens.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at 4°C/40°F or below; use within 4 days. Cool cooked mixtures in shallow containers; do not leave at room temperature for more than 2 hours.

Flavor reference: Polynesian Cultural Center: Easy Palusami Recipe
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Tongan lū-inspired coconut-tomato foundation

A meat-free sauce inspired by lū pulu's coconut, onion and optional tomato. It is not lū pulu itself: pulu refers to the beef component and lū to taro leaves.

coconut tomato-tang allium

rich body allium acid and body thinning seasoning

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

½ cup	● unsweetened canned coconut cream
50 g	● finely chopped onion
75 g	● chopped ripe tomato
2 tbsp	● water
⅛ tsp	● fine salt

Make it

1. Combine coconut cream, onion, tomato, water and salt in a saucepan.
2. Simmer gently over low heat for 10–12 minutes, stirring, until onion is tender and tomato softens.
3. Use immediately with fully cooked vegetables or cool promptly and refrigerate.

WHERE IT SHINES

Spoon over cooked greens or baked mushrooms; the original wrapped baking technique is a separate preparation.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tbsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

A coconut-onion-only version is simpler; do not call a vegetable adaptation lū pulu or claim it duplicates corned beef.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly in a clean covered container at 4°C/40°F or below; use within 4 days. Cool cooked mixtures in shallow containers; do not leave at room temperature for more than 2 hours.

Flavor reference: Alamoti Taumoepeau / Polynesian Cultural Center: Tongan Lūpulu
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Hawaiian ‘inamona-inspired macadamia sprinkle

An original macadamia approximation inspired by ‘inamona's roasted-nut savor. True ‘inamona uses properly roasted kukui; this is not ‘inamona and contains no raw candlenuts.

roasted-nut rich salty

Measured volumes before mixing • whole and ground forms as specified

Measure • 1× ingredient batch

- 2 tbsp
- unsalted roasted macadamia nuts
- ⅛ tsp
- fine sea salt

Make it

1. Use commercially roasted food-grade macadamias; crush to a coarse meal.
2. Mix evenly with the measured salt.
3. Seal in a clean dry container and refrigerate; discard if rancid.

WHERE IT SHINES

Sprinkle over cooked tofu, steamed vegetables or rice.

STARTING AMOUNT • ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.5 tsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Purchased ready-to-eat ‘inamona provides a different authentic flavor; follow its label. Do not substitute raw kukui or attempt unverified home processing.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

macadamia/tree nuts

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate in an airtight container; use within 1 month for best quality. Keep dry.

Flavor reference: Ka'iwakiloumoku / Kamehameha Schools Hawaiian Cultural Center: 'Inamona
Home interpretation; not kitchen-tested

Andre's Twelve — suggested starting batch

Your exact ingredient list has no verified fixed name. This proposed measured batch is curry-style; your actual proportions remain unknown.

savory earthy warm-hot



Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- | | |
|----------|--------------------------|
| 1 tsp | ● Onion powder |
| 1 tsp | ● Garlic powder |
| 1 tsp | ● Pure mild chile powder |
| 1/8 tsp | ● Cayenne |
| 3 tsp | ● Ground coriander |
| 2 tsp | ● Ground cumin |
| 1/2 tsp | ● Ground black pepper |
| 1 tsp | ● Ground turmeric |
| 1/16 tsp | ● Ground cloves |
| 2 tsp | ● Paprika |
| 1/2 tsp | ● Ground mustard |
| 1/2 tsp | ● Ground ginger |

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES

Cook into a sauce or use as a roast seasoning.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.5 tsp per cup sauce.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Pure chile powder keeps the list at twelve. Premixed American chili powder may add oregano, salt or more cumin.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Mustard; check every packaged powder.

KEEPING IT

Keep airtight, cool and dark. Make small batches; use within 1–3 months for aroma.

Flavor reference: Curry powder family comparison — not an exact match
Home recreation; not kitchen-tested

Big Mac-style pickle-mustard burger sauce

An original home approximation of the creamy pickle-mustard profile; no proprietary formula or brand affiliation.

tangy creamy pickle

creamy base sweet-tart pickle pungency carrier & balance savory foundation body & color

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

4 tbsp	● Commercial mayonnaise
1 tbsp	● Sweet pickle relish
1 tsp	● Prepared yellow mustard
½ tsp	● White vinegar
¼ tsp	● Onion powder
⅛ tsp	● Sweet paprika

Make it

1. Stir ingredients together until uniform.
2. Refrigerate for 30 minutes so the onion hydrates.
3. Serve with cooked burgers or vegetables using a clean spoon.

WHERE IT SHINES

Burger-style dip.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tbsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Ketchup changes the profile; this version omits it.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Egg; mustard; check relish and mayonnaise.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly at 4°C / 40°F or colder; use within 4 days, or earlier if an ingredient label requires it. Never store garlic-oil mixtures at room temperature.

Flavor reference: McDonald's: ingredient and allergen reference
Home recreation; not kitchen-tested

Chick-fil-A-style smoky mustard dip

A home recreation inspired by the brand's publicly described mustard and smoky tang.

smoky sweet mustard

creamy base pungency sweetness smoky sweetness carrier & balance

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 3 tbsp ● Commercial mayonnaise
- 1 tsp ● Prepared yellow mustard
- 2 tsp ● Honey
- 2 tsp ● Prepared barbecue sauce
- ½ tsp ● Lemon juice

Make it

1. Whisk all ingredients together.
2. Refrigerate for 20 minutes.
3. Taste with cooked food; adjust mustard or lemon in small increments.

WHERE IT SHINES

Dip for baked tenders or vegetable sticks.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tbsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Barbecue sauces differ in smoke and sweetness, so the result varies.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Egg; mustard; sauces may contain soy or other allergens.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly at 4°C / 40°F or colder; use within 4 days, or earlier if an ingredient label requires it. Never store garlic-oil mixtures at room temperature.

Flavor reference: Chick-fil-A: sauce ingredients and flavor profile
Home recreation; not kitchen-tested

Cane's-inspired peppery tomato dip

A peppery creamy home interpretation. Raising Cane's says its formula is secret; these are our own proportions.

peppery tangy savory

creamy base sweet tomato savory depth heat & bite savory foundation

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 4 tbsp ● Commercial mayonnaise
- 2 tbsp ● Ketchup
- ½ tsp ● Worcestershire sauce
- ½ tsp ● Ground black pepper
- ¼ tsp ● Garlic powder

Make it

1. Whisk until even.
2. Refrigerate for at least 30 minutes.
3. Sample with cooked food and adjust pepper gradually.

WHERE IT SHINES

Creamy dip for fries or roasted vegetables.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tbsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

For fish-free preparation use a verified fish-free Worcestershire; flavor will vary.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Egg; fish in many Worcestershire brands; check labels.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly at 4°C / 40°F or colder; use within 4 days, or earlier if an ingredient label requires it. Never store garlic-oil mixtures at room temperature.

Flavor reference: Raising Cane's: public sauce description

Home recreation; not kitchen-tested

KFC-inspired pepper & herb seasoning

An original pepper-and-herb coating flavor inspired by fried-chicken style; not the secret eleven-spice formula.

peppery herbal savory



Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- | | |
|-------|-----------------------|
| 2 tsp | ● Sweet paprika |
| 1 tsp | ● Ground white pepper |
| ½ tsp | ● Ground black pepper |
| 1 tsp | ● Garlic powder |
| ½ tsp | ● Onion powder |
| ½ tsp | ● Dried thyme |
| ½ tsp | ● Dried basil |
| ¼ tsp | ● Dried oregano |
| ¼ tsp | ● Ground ginger |

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES

Use in a cooked breading or roasted vegetable coating.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tsp per cup flour for a complete coating recipe; cook flour before eating.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Pressure frying is a separate commercial technique; do not attempt it in a domestic pressure cooker.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No major allergen inherent; flour and other coating ingredients may add wheat, egg or dairy.

KEEPING IT

Keep airtight, cool and dark. Make small batches; use within 1–3 months for aroma.

Flavor reference: KFC: recipe secrecy and commercial preparation
Home recreation; not kitchen-tested

Chipotle-style smoky adobo marinade

An original smoky chile–garlic marinade inspired by burrito–grill adobo flavor.

smoky earthy tangy

heat & bite carrier & balance flavor carrier savory foundation earthy base herbal lift

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- | | |
|----------|---|
| 1 tbsp | ● Canned chipotle chiles in adobo, minced |
| 2 tbsp | ● Lime juice |
| 1 tbsp | ● Neutral oil |
| 2 pieces | ● Fresh garlic cloves, minced |
| ½ tsp | ● Ground cumin |
| ½ tsp | ● Dried Mexican oregano |

Make it

1. Blend into a spoonable marinade.
2. Use 2 tbsp per 450 g vegetables; marinate refrigerated for 20 minutes.
3. Reserve a clean serving portion before contact with any raw animal food; discard used marinade.

WHERE IT SHINES

Grilled vegetable filling.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 2 tbsp per 450 g food.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

This is our own recipe; canned adobo brands vary and contribute salt.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Check canned adobo labels; possible wheat or other additives.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly at 4°C / 40°F or colder; use within 4 days, or earlier if an ingredient label requires it. Never store garlic–oil mixtures at room temperature.

Flavor reference: Chipotle: public ingredient information
Home recreation; not kitchen-tested

Panda-style orange glaze

An original sweet-tart orange glaze inspired by orange-chicken style; not a disclosed brand recipe.

orange sweet-tart glossy

carrier & balance sweetness carrier & balance savory depth warm aroma thickener liquid base

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

¼ cup	● Orange juice
1 tbsp	● Sugar
1 tbsp	● Rice vinegar
1 tsp	● Soy sauce
½ tsp	● Fresh ginger, grated
1 tsp	● Cornstarch
2 tsp	● Water

Make it

1. Whisk cornstarch with the water in a separate cup.
2. Simmer juice, sugar, vinegar, soy sauce and ginger for 2 minutes.
3. Whisk in slurry and simmer 1–2 minutes until glossy; use on separately cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES

Glaze cooked vegetables or a fully cooked protein.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tbsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Orange zest can increase aroma; this differs from any proprietary sauce.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Soy; wheat in many soy sauces.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly at 4°C / 40°F or colder; use within 4 days, or earlier if an ingredient label requires it. Never store garlic–oil mixtures at room temperature.

Flavor reference: Panda Express: official ingredients

Home recreation; not kitchen-tested

Wingstop-style lemon-pepper butter

A home citrus-pepper finish inspired by the publicly named flavor.

lemony peppery buttery

carrier & balance citrus aroma heat & bite savory foundation

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 2 tbsp ● Unsalted butter
- 1 tsp ● Finely grated fresh lemon zest
- ½ tsp ● Ground black pepper
- ⅛ tsp ● Garlic powder

Make it

1. Melt butter gently, without browning.
2. Remove from heat and stir in zest, pepper and garlic.
3. Toss with already cooked vegetables or food just before serving.

WHERE IT SHINES

Warm finishing sauce.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Use fresh zest here; commercial lemon-pepper seasoning often includes salt or citric acid.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Milk.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly at 4°C / 40°F or colder; use within 4 days, or earlier if an ingredient label requires it. Never store garlic-oil mixtures at room temperature.

Flavor reference: Wingstop: lemon pepper flavor reference
Home recreation; not kitchen-tested

Olive Garden-style herb vinaigrette

An original oil–vinegar–herb dressing evoking the familiar Italian-American restaurant profile.

tangy herbal savory

flavor carrier carrier & balance liquid base pungency herbal lift savory foundation sweetness heat & bite

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

3 tbsp	● Olive oil
2 tbsp	● White wine vinegar
1 tbsp	● Water
½ tsp	● Prepared Dijon mustard
½ tsp	● Dried oregano
¼ tsp	● Garlic powder
½ tsp	● Sugar
⅛ tsp	● Ground black pepper

Make it

1. Shake in a clean lidded jar.
2. Refrigerate 20 minutes to hydrate herbs.
3. Shake again before dressing a salad.

WHERE IT SHINES

Dress leafy greens or cooked grain salads.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 1 tbsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Parmesan may be added at the table; the brand's formula is not asserted.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Mustard; verify wine vinegar ingredients.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate promptly at 4°C / 40°F or colder; use within 4 days, or earlier if an ingredient label requires it. Never store garlic–oil mixtures at room temperature.

Flavor reference: Olive Garden: signature dressing reference
Home recreation; not kitchen-tested

Mushrooms → smoky bacon cues

Aim for smoke, browned savoriness, gentle sweetness and crisp edges; mushrooms retain their own flavor.

smoky savory crisp

savory depth flavor carrier sweetness body & color savory depth

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

200 g	● King oyster mushrooms, thin slices
2 tsp	● Neutral oil
1 tsp	● Maple syrup
½ tsp	● Smoked paprika
½ tsp	● Soy sauce

Make it

1. Toss mushrooms with oil; spread without overlap.
2. Roast at 180°C / 356°F for 20 minutes; turn and watch closely another 10–20 minutes.
3. Brush with maple, paprika and soy mixture; roast 2–3 minutes and cool to crisp.

WHERE IT SHINES

Top salads or a mushroom–lettuce sandwich.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Makes about 2 small topping portions.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Smoke + browning + sweet-salty contrast evokes bacon cues without duplicating pork.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Soy; wheat in many soy sauces.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate leftovers promptly at 4°C / 40°F or colder; use within 4 days. Crisp toppings lose texture; prepare small batches.

Flavor reference: Kenji López-Alt: crisp mushroom-bacon technique
Flavor experiment; not kitchen-tested

Carrot ribbons → smoked-salmon cues

A lox-style vegetable topping with soft ribbons, smoke, acid and a seaweed hint; not raw fish or a nutritional equivalent.

smoky briny silky

vegetable body flavor carrier carrier & balance carrier & balance smoke aroma ocean aroma herbal lift

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

200 g	● Carrots, peeled
1 tsp	● Olive oil
2 tsp	● Lemon juice
1 tsp	● Rice vinegar
1/16 tsp	● Food-grade liquid smoke
¼ tsp	● Nori, finely crumbled
1 tsp	● Fresh dill, chopped

Make it

1. Shave carrots into ribbons and steam 4–7 minutes until flexible.
2. Cool promptly, then toss with the remaining ingredients.
3. Refrigerate 30 minutes and serve cold on toast.

WHERE IT SHINES

Use as a smoky carrot garnish.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Makes about 2 topping portions.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Texture, smoke and a marine aroma create resemblance; the carrot sweetness remains.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Check liquid smoke, nori and vinegar labels.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate leftovers promptly at 4°C / 40°F or colder; use within 4 days. Crisp toppings lose texture; prepare small batches.

Flavor reference: Jeanine Donofrio: carrot lox concept
Flavor experiment; not kitchen-tested

Chickpeas → tuna-salad cues

A savory sandwich mash built around flaky texture, lemon, dill and seaweed; resemblance is subjective.

savory lemony marine

hearty base creamy base carrier & balance savory foundation herbal lift ocean aroma heat & bite

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 1 cup ● Cooked chickpeas, drained
- 1 tbsp ● Commercial mayonnaise
- 1 tsp ● Lemon juice
- 2 tbsp ● Fresh celery, finely chopped
- 1 tsp ● Fresh dill, chopped
- ¼ tsp ● Nori, finely crumbled
- ⅛ tsp ● Ground black pepper

Make it

1. Mash chickpeas coarsely so small flakes remain.
2. Fold in the remaining ingredients.
3. Chill 20 minutes and serve in a sandwich.

WHERE IT SHINES

Sandwich filling.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Makes 2 small filling portions.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Briny aroma + tang + coarse flakes suggest a deli salad; it is not fish.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Egg; celery; chickpeas; check nori labels.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate leftovers promptly at 4°C / 40°F or colder; use within 4 days. Crisp toppings lose texture; prepare small batches.

Flavor reference: Love and Lemons: chickpea sandwich structure

Flavor experiment; not kitchen-tested

Frozen banana → chocolate soft-serve cues

A creamy frozen-fruit dessert; banana remains noticeable despite cocoa and vanilla.

chocolate creamy fruity

creamy fruit body roast bitterness sweet aroma creamy body

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 200 g ● Peeled ripe banana, sliced and frozen
- 2 tsp ● Unsweetened cocoa powder
- ¼ tsp ● Vanilla extract
- 1 tbsp ● Milk or chosen labeled alternative

Make it

1. Let frozen slices soften for 3 minutes.
2. Process with cocoa and vanilla, adding the tablespoon of liquid only if needed.
3. Serve immediately while soft.

WHERE IT SHINES

Small frozen dessert.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Makes 2 small portions.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Cold fruit structure creates creaminess; cocoa redirects the aroma toward chocolate dessert.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Milk if used; alternatives may contain soy, nuts or oats.

KEEPING IT

Eat immediately for soft texture or freeze airtight; thaw only enough to scoop.

Flavor reference: Love and Lemons: banana ice cream technique

Flavor experiment; not kitchen-tested

Cauliflower → pepperoni-pizza cues

A vegetable topping using fennel, smoke, garlic and chile to evoke pizza-seasoning associations.

smoky fennel garlicky

vegetable body flavor carrier body & color earthy base savory foundation herbal lift heat & bite

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

200 g	● Cauliflower florets, finely chopped
2 tsp	● Olive oil
½ tsp	● Smoked paprika
¼ tsp	● Ground fennel seed
¼ tsp	● Garlic powder
¼ tsp	● Dried oregano
⅛ tsp	● Crushed red pepper

Make it

1. Toss cauliflower with oil and all spices.
2. Roast at 210°C / 410°F for 18–25 minutes until browned.
3. Use on cooked tomato toast or a baked pizza.

WHERE IT SHINES

Vegetable pizza topping.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Makes about 2 topping portions.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Fennel and paprika suggest cured-meat seasoning; cauliflower does not become meat.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

No major allergen inherent; toppings may add wheat or dairy.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate leftovers promptly at 4°C / 40°F or colder; use within 4 days. Crisp toppings lose texture; prepare small batches.

Flavor reference: Original MasterCook sensory experiment

Flavor experiment; not kitchen-tested

Apple & toasted oats → apple-pie cues

A quick skillet dessert using warm spice and a toasted grain crunch.

cinnamon buttery toasty

fruit body grain body carrier & balance sweetness warm aroma sweet aroma liquid base

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

200 g	● Apple, cored and diced
3 tbsp	● Rolled oats
2 tsp	● Unsalted butter
1 tsp	● Sugar
¼ tsp	● Ground cinnamon
⅛ tsp	● Vanilla extract
2 tbsp	● Water

Make it

1. Toast oats in half the butter in a skillet for 3–4 minutes, then set aside.
2. Cook apple with remaining butter, sugar, cinnamon and water for 7–10 minutes until tender.
3. Add vanilla off heat and scatter toasted oats on top.

WHERE IT SHINES

Small spoon dessert.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Makes 2 small portions.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Warm apple aroma and toasted grain imitate pie cues without a pastry crust.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Milk; oats may have wheat cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate leftovers promptly at 4°C / 40°F or colder; use within 4 days. Crisp toppings lose texture; prepare small batches.

Flavor reference: Original MasterCook sensory experiment

Flavor experiment; not kitchen-tested

Carrots → smoky hot-dog cues

A playful cooked-carrot sandwich filling; texture and nutrition differ from a sausage.

smoky mustardy savory

vegetable body liquid base savory depth carrier & balance sweetness pungency body & color earthy base

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

2 pieces	● Peeled carrots
¼ cup	● Water
1 tsp	● Soy sauce
2 tsp	● Apple cider vinegar
1 tsp	● Maple syrup
½ tsp	● Prepared mustard
½ tsp	● Smoked paprika
⅛ tsp	● Ground coriander

Make it

1. Simmer carrots in plain water for 12–20 minutes until fork-tender; drain.
2. Combine measured water and all seasonings; simmer carrots in that sauce 5 minutes.
3. Transfer to a lightly oiled skillet and brown briefly; serve warm.

WHERE IT SHINES

Cooked vegetable sandwich filling.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Makes 2 carrot fillings.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Smoke, mustard, coriander and sweetness suggest a hot-dog profile, but the carrot stays sweet and vegetal.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Soy; mustard; wheat in many soy sauces.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate leftovers promptly at 4°C / 40°F or colder; use within 4 days. Crisp toppings lose texture; prepare small batches.

Flavor reference: Shane & Simple – carrot hot dogs; sensory method reference, original shorter home variation
Flavor experiment; not kitchen-tested

Vanilla grapes → cheesecake cues

A tiny cold snack pairing a fresh fruit pop with creamy vanilla and tart dairy; an untested sensory experiment.

vanilla tart creamy

fruit body creamy body creamy body sweet aroma citrus aroma crumb crunch

Ingredient roles · no volume comparison across unlike measures

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

100 g	● Seedless grapes, washed and halved
2 tbsp	● Plain Greek yogurt
1 tbsp	● Cream cheese
⅛ tsp	● Vanilla extract
¼ tsp	● Finely grated lemon zest
1 tbsp	● Crushed graham cracker

Make it

1. Stir yogurt, cream cheese, vanilla and lemon zest until smooth.
2. Fold in grape halves.
3. Scatter cracker crumbs just before eating.

WHERE IT SHINES

Cold spoon snack.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Makes 2 small portions.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Vanilla, tang, creaminess and biscuit aroma suggest cheesecake; grapes are still grapes.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Milk; wheat in graham crackers.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate leftovers promptly at 4°C / 40°F or colder; use within 4 days. Crisp toppings lose texture; prepare small batches.

Flavor reference: Original MasterCook sensory experiment
Flavor experiment; not kitchen-tested

Desert Planet: ember & citrus

Dune-inspired desert mood; an original culinary proposal with ordinary food ingredients, not an official franchise recipe.

smoky citrus warm



Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 2 tsp ● Smoked paprika
- 2 tsp ● Ground coriander
- ½ tsp ● Ground ginger
- ½ tsp ● Food-grade dried orange peel, powdered
- ¼ tsp ● Ground cardamom
- 1/16 tsp ● Cayenne

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES
Roasted carrots or squash.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE
Start with 0.25 tsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS
Smoky mineral-colored spice meets orange and cardamom; this contains ordinary culinary ingredients, not fictional spice.

ALLERGENS & LABELS
Check all packaged ingredients and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT
Airtight, cool and dark; use within 1 month for aroma. Keep completely dry.

Flavor reference: Original MasterCook formulation inspired by the stated fictional mood
Original experiment; not kitchen-tested

Doom Mountain: cocoa-coffee fire

Mordor-inspired volcanic mood; an original culinary proposal with ordinary food ingredients, not an official franchise recipe.

bitter-roast smoky hot



Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 2 tsp Unsweetened cocoa powder
- ½ tsp Instant coffee powder
- 1 tsp Smoked paprika
- 1 tsp Ground cumin
- ½ tsp Garlic powder
- ⅛ tsp Cayenne

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES
Roasted mushrooms or a savory bean sauce.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE
Start with 0.25 tsp per cup sauce.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS
Cocoa and coffee add roast bitterness: start tiny, as the blend can overwhelm. Contains caffeine from coffee; decaffeinated instant coffee is an alternative.

ALLERGENS & LABELS
Check all packaged ingredients and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT
Airtight, cool and dark; use within 1 month for aroma. Keep completely dry.

Flavor reference: Original MasterCook formulation inspired by the stated fictional mood
Original experiment; not kitchen-tested

Shire Rain: woodland pantry

Tolkien-inspired cozy countryside; an original culinary proposal with ordinary food ingredients, not an official franchise recipe.

woody savory herbal



Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 2 tsp ● Store-bought dried porcini powder
- 2 tsp ● Onion powder
- 1 tsp ● Dried thyme
- ½ tsp ● Dried rosemary, finely crushed
- ¼ tsp ● Ground black pepper
- 1/16 tsp ● Ground nutmeg

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES

Cook into a mushroom sauce or a potato bake.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.5 tsp per cup sauce.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Only purchased edible dried mushrooms; no foraged or unidentified fungi. Cook the blend into the dish.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Check all packaged ingredients and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Airtight, cool and dark; use within 1 month for aroma. Keep completely dry.

Flavor reference: Original MasterCook formulation inspired by the stated fictional mood
Original experiment; not kitchen-tested

Wizard Tavern: butterbrew dust

Wizard-school tavern mood; an original culinary proposal with ordinary food ingredients, not an official franchise recipe.

butterscotch warm vanilla

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 4 tsp ● Brown sugar
- 2 tsp ● Nonfat dry milk powder
- ¼ tsp ● Ground cinnamon
- 1/16 tsp ● Ground nutmeg
- ⅛ tsp ● Vanilla powder, food-grade

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES

Warm popcorn lightly coated in butter.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.5 tsp per cup popcorn.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

A dessert dust evoking butter-caramel cues; not an official Butterbeer formula.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Milk.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate airtight and dry; use within 2 weeks for quality or an earlier ingredient-label limit.

Flavor reference: Original MasterCook formulation inspired by the stated fictional mood
Original experiment; not kitchen-tested

Neon Noodle Glitch

Cyberpunk-night-market mood; an original culinary proposal with ordinary food ingredients, not an official franchise recipe.

citrus tingling chili



Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 2 tsp ● Ground sumac
- ½ tsp ● Ground Sichuan pepper husks
- 1 tsp ● Pure mild red chile powder
- 1 tsp ● Toasted sesame seeds
- ¼ tsp ● Ground ginger

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES

A finishing accent for cooked noodles or cucumber salad.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.125 tsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Sumac acidity and Sichuan tingle collide; sensation is not a guarantee of a particular taste.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Sesame.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate airtight and dry; use within 2 weeks for quality or an earlier ingredient-label limit.

Flavor reference: Original MasterCook formulation inspired by the stated fictional mood
Original experiment; not kitchen-tested

Sea Temple: citrus & nori

Atlantis-inspired ocean mythology; an original culinary proposal with ordinary food ingredients, not an official franchise recipe.

marine bright toasty



Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 2 tsp ● Nori, finely crumbled
- 2 tsp ● Toasted sesame seeds
- ½ tsp ● Food-grade dried lemon peel, powdered
- ½ tsp ● Dried dill
- ¼ tsp ● Ground ginger

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES
Roasted vegetables or a rice bowl.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE
Start with 0.25 tsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS
Nori introduces an ocean aroma; this is a fantasy house mixture, not a historical Atlantean recipe.

ALLERGENS & LABELS
Sesame.

KEEPING IT
Refrigerate airtight and dry; use within 2 weeks for quality or an earlier ingredient-label limit.

Flavor reference: Original MasterCook formulation inspired by the stated fictional mood
Original experiment; not kitchen-tested

Dragon Hoard: gold & cacao

Dragon-lair fantasy mood; an original culinary proposal with ordinary food ingredients, not an official franchise recipe.

golden earthy dark



Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 2 tsp ● Ground coriander
- ½ tsp ● Ground turmeric
- 1 tsp ● Unsweetened cocoa powder
- ¼ tsp ● Ground cinnamon
- ¼ tsp ● Ground black pepper
- ¼ tsp ● Pure red chile powder

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES
Cook into a roasted squash sauce.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE
Start with 0.25 tsp per cup sauce.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS
Cacao plus coriander gives a deliberately savory dark-gold contrast.

ALLERGENS & LABELS
Check all packaged ingredients and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT
Airtight, cool and dark; use within 1 month for aroma. Keep completely dry.

Flavor reference: Original MasterCook formulation inspired by the stated fictional mood
Original experiment; not kitchen-tested

Fairy Orchard: berry & pepper

A Midsummer Night's Dream mood; an original culinary proposal with ordinary food ingredients, not an official franchise recipe.

fruity floral peppery

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 2 tsp ● Freeze-dried strawberry powder
- 1 tsp ● Ground sumac
- ⅛ tsp ● Ground black pepper
- 1/16 tsp ● Culinary English lavender (*Lavandula angustifolia*), crushed
- 1 tsp ● Sugar

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES

A tiny sprinkle over plain yogurt or a baked fruit dessert.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.125 tsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Use purchased food-grade culinary lavender only, never potpourri or decorative flowers. Keep the tiny stated amount; excess tastes perfumy.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Check all packaged ingredients and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Airtight, cool and dark; use within 1 month for aroma. Keep completely dry.

Flavor reference: Original MasterCook formulation inspired by the stated fictional mood
Original experiment; not kitchen-tested

Space Cantina: tamarind comet

Space-opera cantina mood; an original culinary proposal with ordinary food ingredients, not an official franchise recipe.

tart smoky earthy



Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 1 tsp ● Tamarind powder, pure food-grade
- 1 tsp ● Smoked paprika
- ½ tsp ● Ground cumin
- 1 tsp ● Ground coriander
- ½ tsp ● Garlic powder
- 1/16 tsp ● Cayenne

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES

Cook into a vegetable glaze with a spoon of water and oil.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.25 tsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Check tamarind powder for sugar or maltodextrin; products differ in sourness.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Check all packaged ingredients and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Airtight, cool and dark; use within 1 month for aroma. Keep completely dry.

Flavor reference: Original MasterCook formulation inspired by the stated fictional mood
Original experiment; not kitchen-tested

Vampire Velvet: crimson roast

Dracula-inspired gothic mood; an original culinary proposal with ordinary food ingredients, not an official franchise recipe.

dark tart earthy



Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 2 tsp ● Unsweetened cocoa powder
- 1 tsp ● Freeze-dried beet powder
- 1 tsp ● Ground sumac
- ½ tsp ● Smoked paprika
- ⅓ tsp ● Ground black pepper

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES
Cook into roasted mushroom or beet sauce.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE
Start with 0.25 tsp per cup sauce.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS
Beet earthiness, cacao bitterness and tart sumac: an intentionally odd savory experiment.

ALLERGENS & LABELS
Check all packaged ingredients and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT
Airtight, cool and dark; use within 1 month for aroma. Keep completely dry.

Flavor reference: Original MasterCook formulation inspired by the stated fictional mood
Original experiment; not kitchen-tested

Eldritch Library: tea & porcini

Cosmic-horror library mood; an original culinary proposal with ordinary food ingredients, not an official franchise recipe.

toasty woody warm



Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- ¼ tsp ● Instant black tea powder, plain food-grade
- 1 tsp ● Store-bought dried porcini powder
- 1 tsp ● Ground coriander
- ½ tsp ● Ground ginger
- ⅛ tsp ● Ground cinnamon

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES
Cook into a mushroom-broth sauce.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE
Start with 0.125 tsp per cup sauce.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS
Use instant culinary tea, not coarse dry leaves; both tea and mushrooms have distinct bitterness. Contains caffeine.

ALLERGENS & LABELS
Check all packaged ingredients and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT
Airtight, cool and dark; use within 1 month for aroma. Keep completely dry.

Flavor reference: Original MasterCook formulation inspired by the stated fictional mood
Original experiment; not kitchen-tested

Wonderland Tea Cake

Alice-inspired tea-party mood; an original culinary proposal with ordinary food ingredients, not an official franchise recipe.

tea citrus sweet-spiced

Measured volumes before mixing · whole and ground forms as specified

Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 3 tsp ● Sugar
- ½ tsp ● Ground ginger
- ½ tsp ● Food-grade dried orange peel, powdered
- ¼ tsp ● Ground fennel
- ⅛ tsp ● Instant black tea powder, plain

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES

Sprinkle lightly over baked toast or folded into plain oatmeal.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.25 tsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Tea, fennel and orange create a deliberately unusual dessert aroma. Contains caffeine.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Check all packaged ingredients and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT

Airtight, cool and dark; use within 1 month for aroma. Keep completely dry.

Flavor reference: Original MasterCook formulation inspired by the stated fictional mood
Original experiment; not kitchen-tested

Pirate Map: coffee & plantain spice

Treasure-island adventure mood; an original culinary proposal with ordinary food ingredients, not an official franchise recipe.

roasty warm smoky



Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 1 tsp ● Ground cinnamon
- ¼ tsp ● Instant coffee powder
- ½ tsp ● Smoked paprika
- ½ tsp ● Ground ginger
- 2 tsp ● Brown sugar

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES
A tiny dusting over separately cooked ripe plantain.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE
Start with 0.125 tsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS
Sweet plantain is the anchor; smoke and coffee keep the fruit from feeling purely dessert-like. Contains caffeine.

ALLERGENS & LABELS
Check all packaged ingredients and cross-contact.

KEEPING IT
Airtight, cool and dark; use within 1 month for aroma. Keep completely dry.

Flavor reference: Original MasterCook formulation inspired by the stated fictional mood
Original experiment; not kitchen-tested

Monster Hunter: forest mustard

Witcher-inspired forest mood; an original culinary proposal with ordinary food ingredients, not an official franchise recipe.

resinous mustard peppery



Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 1 tsp ● Ground mustard
- ½ tsp ● Dried sage, rubbed
- ½ tsp ● Dried thyme
- ⅛ tsp ● Purchased food-grade culinary juniper, ground
- ¼ tsp ● Ground black pepper
- 1 tsp ● Onion powder

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES
Cook into a vegetable roast or sauce.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE
Start with 0.125 tsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS
Only purchased culinary Juniperus communis berries; omit juniper and use 0.125 tsp rosemary if unavailable. No foraging.

ALLERGENS & LABELS
Mustard.

KEEPING IT
Airtight, cool and dark; use within 1 month for aroma. Keep completely dry.

Flavor reference: Original MasterCook formulation inspired by the stated fictional mood
Original experiment; not kitchen-tested

Solar Hero: pineapple & smoke

Bright comic-book action mood; an original culinary proposal with ordinary food ingredients, not an official franchise recipe.

fruity smoky coconut



Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 2 tsp ● Freeze-dried pineapple powder
- 1 tsp ● Smoked paprika
- 2 tsp ● Unsweetened desiccated coconut, finely ground
- ½ tsp ● Ground coriander
- 1/16 tsp ● Cayenne

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES

A finishing dust for roasted corn or cooked squash.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.25 tsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Check fruit powders: pure dried fruit differs from sweetened drink mixes.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Coconut; check all packaged ingredients.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate airtight and dry; use within 2 weeks for quality or an earlier ingredient-label limit.

Flavor reference: Original MasterCook formulation inspired by the stated fictional mood
Original experiment; not kitchen-tested

Lunar Library: sesame eclipse

Moonlit magical-girl mood; an original culinary proposal with ordinary food ingredients, not an official franchise recipe.

sesame cacao citrus



Measure · 1× ingredient batch

- 2 tsp ● Toasted black sesame seeds, coarsely ground
- 1 tsp ● Unsweetened cocoa powder
- ½ tsp ● Food-grade dried orange peel, powdered
- 1 tsp ● Sugar
- ⅛ tsp ● Ground cardamom

Make it

1. Measure ground spices into a dry bowl. Crush any dried herbs between your fingers.
2. Whisk thoroughly and transfer to a clean dry jar. Label with the blend name and date.
3. Add a small amount first; increase only after tasting the cooked food.

WHERE IT SHINES

A dessert accent on plain yogurt or a warm rice pudding.

STARTING AMOUNT · ORIGINAL REFERENCE

Start with 0.25 tsp per serving.

VARIATION / WHY IT WORKS

Black sesame and cacao produce darkness without charcoal, ink, metallic powder or decorative glitter.

ALLERGENS & LABELS

Sesame.

KEEPING IT

Refrigerate airtight and dry; use within 2 weeks for quality or an earlier ingredient-label limit.

Flavor reference: Original MasterCook formulation inspired by the stated fictional mood
Original experiment; not kitchen-tested

A small, honest flavor lab.

For a first trial, cook one small base portion and divide it into three tastes. Keep one unchanged; add a little acidity to the second and a little toasted or smoky aroma to the third. Write down exact measures, what food carried the seasoning, and what you actually tasted. A fantasy name describes a mood; it is never evidence that the blend tastes good.

Restaurant names identify flavor inspiration. No proprietary formula, endorsement or affiliation is claimed. Flavor illusions aim for recognizable cues; they do not turn a food into another food or make it nutritionally equivalent.

Sources link to the creators or official public flavor references consulted. The measured recipes and instructions here are original home formulations or transparent pantry interpretations, not claimed reproductions of those sources. Original experiments have no outside recipe source.

Recipe references describe cooking traditions, not clinical approval. Nutrition has not been calculated. Ingredient brands, individual restrictions and portions matter.